I'll be whole, but I don't know when

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/33457933.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Categories:
F/F, F/M, Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra & Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Marlena (He-Man), Randor (He-Man), Original Characters, Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff and Angst, Angst with a Happy Ending, Eating Disorders, Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Implied/Referenced Homophobia, Alternate Universe - College/University, Alternate Universe - Human, Emotional Hurt/Comfort

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by Sof_WR20

Summary

Adora had a rough path her entire life, and it didn’t get better until she was 17, when she finally got out of her toxic household and went to live with her best friend. Everything in Adora's life was going well, from going to college to having new friends.

Adora and Catra thought that everything was going to be fine as long as they had each other, so what happens when Adora's past comes back to torment her once again.

TW: Read at your own precaution, this work includes mentions of Homophobia and Eating Disorders

Notes

Hi!!, So this idea has been in my mind for quite a while, and as the summary mentions, this work has several if not most of the chapters mentioning Homophobia and eating disorders. If anyone read it and has a problem with it, you can send me a message. Everything in here is mostly my experience so if I get something wrong consider that.
I hope you'll like it, and again, if something offended someone you're free of sending me a message, besides that, maybe the work can have some spell errors, English it's not my native language so consider that.
Read at your own precautions.
Remember, you are good enough just the way you are!

See the end of the work for more notes

Friends . . Old Friends . . .

"Hope knows no fear. Hope dares to blossom even inside the abysmal abyss. Hope secretly feeds and strengthens promise"

- Sri Chinmoy, My Christmas-New Year-Vacation-Aspiration-Prayers Part 26

"So are you ready?", Bow said as everyone was making their way to the tables outside; so they could have lunch together; the day was sunny, just some clouds here and there. Bow was walking next to Adora then turned his face towards the blond as he did his question.

"For what?", Adora questioned back, a smile on her face; she was excited that they were starting classes again, ready to give everything in her second year of college. School for a lot of people was just a nightmare but necessary to be someone in the world, but to Adora it was different, she had always liked it, the opportunity to learn new things was great and college wasn't an exception, because now she wasn't just learning basic human stuff, it was about what she loves the most.

"In five days it's your birthday", Glimmer said next to Bow, joining the conversation

"Oh… right", Adora's smile vanished for a moment before returning, Catra who was at Adora's left side just squeezed her hand and sent her a tiny smile, just to let her know she was there for her.

"So what do you want to do for your birthday?", Glimmer asked her as all of them were grabbing a seat by the table

Catra sat next to Adora, and in front of them were Bow and Glimmer. The four of them were at a lunch table just outside the law campus where Glimmer studied, she was the last one with a class in the morning, and their free hour matched each other.

When they found out about their schedules, they were so happy knowing they would have lunch together.
Adora was socially anxious so making new friends was most of the time a challenge, Catra could make new friends but she didn't like most of the people, always relying on Adora, Glimmer could also make new friends but she had the attitude to make people go away, Bow liked to make new friends but he liked his group so he wanted to be with the best friend squad on his free time.

"I don't know", Adora answered while shrugging, because, in reality, she didn't know, this was her first birthday with a large group of friends. Adora usually didn't do anything on her birthday besides dinner with Catra and her mothers, Cyra and Elena. Adora's birthdays weren't great before, her mother just treated this date like any other day, and her dad used to give her a present in the mornings while saying happy birthday after that she'll be ignored by him for the rest of the day.

To Adora, that day was simply just any other day, maybe the thing that sometimes made it special was that Catra would write her a big letter, this tradition started when they were six years old after the blonde gave her best friend a letter for her birthday, since then, they would give each other a letter on their birthdays, Adora has her letters in a box that it's in her room at Catra's house.

"What do you say if we make you a party?", Glimmer asked, in her eyes was excitement, she was almost jumping in her seat, Bow by her side, looked equally excited.

"Sparkles…", Catra said in a low tone, with a little warning in her voice that made Glimmer turned to her, with a frowning on her face, but before Catra could finish, Adora interrupted her

"Uh, I'm not sure, I'm not a big fan of parties but I'll let you know later okay?, Adora answered with uncertainty in her voice and another shrug, her look was distant, focused on a point at the table. Glimmer and Bow shared a look to then turn around and send a confused look to Catra, but she was focus on her girlfriend, "Dor, are you alright?", her voice tinted with concern and

understatement, she knew why Adora didn’t like parties or this day in general, Catra has been there a long time, long enough to know why Adora was acting so distant.

Adora just nodded her head before putting it on Catra’s shoulder to try and hide her face in her girlfriend's neck, then she proceeded to put her arms around Catra’s waist.

“So... guys how was your first day at school”, Catra asked to change the topic while looking at Adora sideways, she knew her friends must have many questions but if Adora wasn’t ready to give any answers, Catra wouldn’t give any either. Glimmer caught the sudden change of topic and decided it was best to follow that conversation than the last one. As Catra was caressing Adora’s hair, Glimmer responded, “Eh… it could be better, you know it was just introductions, very boring introductions”.

After that, the best friend squad tried to make the conversation flow, but it wasn’t easy given that one of them was really quiet but as time was passing Adora started to join the conversation, but it was just short phrases, her head never leaving Catra’s shoulder, not that the brunette was complaining.

When it was time to return to their classes, the squad said goodbye so everyone could go to their campus. Adora was the first to stand up and leave, she simply waved as a goodbye and went walking to her campus, not giving time for Catra to question if the blonde was alright. Glimmer and Bow were still worried about Adora, but Catra assured them that she would be fine, she was going to talk to her later and if Adora needed anything she would let them know.

When Catra and Adora returned to their home, the blonde went straight to their room. She left her backpack by the door and grabbed some comfortable clothes to be in the house, a top and shorts would be enough, when she finished dressing she went to her bed, laying down on her back, her mind was a mess just as her feelings, they were confusing and overwhelming and sadder.

The remainder of her birthday nagging in her head, this day in previous years were never good, before she left her parents house her birthday consisted of her dad ignoring her while her mother said things about her just making that day, not the best.

When she left at the age of 17, things were getting better, but never as she wanted, Cyra and Elena were amazing just like Catra, and they tried their best so every year Adora could have the best birthday, but deep down on her, things were already destroyed, years and years suffering, with only one person having your back it's not good, and even more, if you feel like a burden to that person. As years passed, without the influence of her mother, Adora was getting better, she could appreciate better the love around her, but her birthday was a bitter reminder of her life with her parents.

Catra knew how her girlfriend felt about this day, Adora had confessed a lot of things to her months later after she had moved to Catra's house. One day Adora had stumbled onto Catra's room crying telling her that she couldn't keep it anymore, that all of her feelings and thoughts were eating her up. They had stayed up until late, Catra hugging Adora as if she would disappear one day, not wanting to let go, that and so many other nights they fell asleep hugging each other with an immense force.

Now, Catra tough this would be a better birthday, having more friends would have helped Adora to like more her birthdays, but she is starting to think that's not the case. Catra and Adora met all of their friends just a year ago, days after Adora's birthday, so they never knew how she could get these days, and knowing Adora she would try to pretend everything is fine.

Catra entered their room, she went to the bathroom not before grabbing comfortable clothes, so she could change. When she returned, she went to the bed and sat down, her back reclined on the headboard, putting her hands on her lap, she turned her head down to the right so she could see Adora, waiting to see if the blonde needed to talk or needed something to distract her.

When Adora didn’t say anything, Catra started to talk, she wanted to see if her girlfriend would want to celebrate with their friends, or she didn’t want anything, maybe this time would be different having more friends could help with that. Catra just wanted to know how her girlfriend was feeling, and what did she need, silence was never a good sign in Adora, her mind always was working and thinking about something, and most of the time she would say what was on her mind so it wouldn’t be flooded with thoughts.

“Dor… how are you feeling?”, Catra started, she tried to talk with a low voice so it would freak Adora, sometimes the blonde could be so deep in her mind that she didn’t notice what was happening around her, and Catra was so used to that, so she knew how to act, move and talk around Adora.

Adora didn’t jump when Catra talked so that meant she wasn’t that deep, but she took several minutes to respond, maybe she was preparing what to say or was organizing her thoughts, “I’m fine, just… I was in shock, I forgot that my birthday it’s in less than a week”

“You know you can talk to me about anything, right?”, Catra grabbed Adora’s left hand and brought it into her lap

“I know, and I’m okay, seriously, it was just the shock of the moment”, Adora said as she squeezed Catra’s hand

“Okay”, Catra sigh, her look went to their front, “So do you want to do anything, Glimmer probably would ask again tomorrow”

When Adora didn’t talk, Catra kept talking, “If you don’t want something then I would tell Glimmer, and don’t worry, they won't get mad at you if you decided not to do something”

“I’m going to do it, maybe it going to be better than past times but I have a condition, I’m not organizing it”, when Adora finished talking she had a tiny smile, now looking at Catra

Catra turned to Adora and shared a smile of her own, she nodded before she continued talking but changing the subject, she considered the birthday talk was ended and thought it was better to rest the evening, “Do you want to watch something, or do we take a nap?”

“A nap would be nice”

Catra went and closed the curtains of their room and after, the door, with that done, she went again to the bed, but this time she lay down on her right side, looking at Adora, the blonde also turned to her right side, so Catra would be spooning her, most of the time Adora liked to be the little spoon, she felt secure around Catra’s arms and the brunette didn't mind, she liked to have her arms around Adora, she felt like she could protect her girlfriend from any harm of the outside world. After they embraced sleep came to them, that nap helped to race down their minds, there would be time later for them to worry, but for now, they could have just peace.

The next day, as the best friend squad was making their way to the cafeteria after some finished classes, Adora was the first to talk after a comfortable silence, surprising everyone with just one phrase, “Glim, you can organize a party if you want”

At this Glimmer stopped walking and by default, Bow, who was grabbing Glimmer by the hand, when the first two stayed still, Catra and Adora also stop walking noticing that their friends weren’t by their sides. The blonde just raised an eyebrow, as if she was asking what was the problem, this seemed to wake Glimmer from whatever trance she was in, and asked nervously, “Are you sure? I mean it’s your birthday after all, do you want a party?”

Adora flinched when Glimmer was at half phrase but try to cover it, “Yes, I talked to Catra yesterday, and we agreed that a party would be fine, but not a massive one just us and a couple of more friends”

Glimmer squealed with happiness, her eyes were bright like they had stars, and after a mini celebration from Glimmer and Bow they kept on walking until they arrived at an available table, immediately after they sat down, the enthusiast duo started to plan the party, in between phrases it could be heard balloons and types of cakes, besides decoration stuff.

Catra turned to Adora, but her girlfriend was watching their friends with amusement and shock on her face, maybe it was the fact that nobody has ever planned a birthday party for her, and it's not that Catra or her mothers hadn't thought about it, but the girls never had any friends, it was just them against the world, so Adora preferred a dinner with her found family, then a big party with strangers.

Adora turned to Catra as she felt like someone was watching her, and in Catra's face it could be seen affection and pure love, Adora felt butterflies in her stomach, and her heart was beating quickly, it was the same feelings Adora would get when she was thinking about Catra, it also felt just like the moment Adora realized that she was in love with Catra. Adora gave her girlfriend a smile that made her cheeks get puffier and get creases around her eyes.

In front of the couple, their friends were still deep discussing how they were going to organize Adora's party, they were writing down on a piece of paper what cake and decorations to buy, who to invite, and how to decorate Catra and Adora's backyard, they look so excited that Adora promised herself to enjoy that day and show everyone that she was having fun not taking importance on the path that her thought would go.

Maybe it would be better.

Maybe from now on, that day was going to be the best as it was supposed to be from the beginning.

Maybe now she can be happy and enjoy that day with people who really love her.

One sees how it ends

Chapter Summary

A birthday celebration starts but past comes knocking on the door.

Chapter Notes

Hi!! I'm back with another chapter.
You'll know if something doesn't seem right, you can't message me or comment about it.
I hope you enjoy it. :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"The brave man is not he who feels no fear,
For that were stupid and irrational;
But he, whose noble soul its fear subdues,
And bravely dares the danger nature shrinks from."
Joanna Baillie, Count Basil (1798), Act III, scene 1, line 151.

As Catra was waking up and her brain started to let go of the sleepy state, she realized that today was Adora's birthday. Catra knew the date by heart, this was one of the most important dates for her, the brunette knows how Adora thinks about this celebration, but Catra always tries to make it the best day for her girlfriend. Adora said days before, like every other year, that she didn't want a present, and Catra respected her wishes, so she had only made her traditional letter the night before after she made sure that Adora was asleep. Catra felt in her heart that today was going to be different; she just hoped it would be the good kind of different.

The brunette got up from her bed rubbing her still sleepy eyes, but before she could exit the room, Catra gave a kiss on the forehead to an Adora who was strangely still sleeping, the blonde was an early riser, sometimes their friends would question why does she wake up so early, and she would say it was because she likes to wake up early.

Catra knows the truth, sometimes, when they were teenagers, Adora would have nightmares that made it harder for her to sleep, or other times the fights against her mother took away her sleep, all of that caused a change in her schedule so as she was growing up she became accustomed to waking up at a certain hour. A few rare times, Adora would sleep after that hour, like today, and Catra every time that it happened, tried to make no sound, so her partner could sleep peacefully.

Catra went to the kitchen to make their breakfast. She was going to do the same food that they always had for breakfast this day all past years, pancakes, and some French toast with some fruit on the side.

Her mothers used to wake her up very early to make Adora breakfast, this was their present to Adora and Catra was always enthusiast to help on making something for her best friend, this breakfast only made them when the duo would have their sleepovers, those usually started the day before the blonde's birthday, and if by chance they couldn't' have their sleepovers, the reason being that Marlena didn't like Adora staying in another place if the next day was school day; Catra and her mothers would do the breakfast, so Adora could eat it for lunch, in either way they would do Adora's favorite breakfast so the blonde could have something positive about her day, so she could feel cared.

When Catra was finishing breakfast, with some minor difficulties out of the way, she heard a noise in the bedroom, most likely it was Adora waking up, so the brunette started to prepare the table, putting what was ready in there. She tried to make it look fancy and sophisticated, but not losing the domestic touch.

Catra finished putting everything in place when Adora opened the door of their bedroom, Catra turned toward the blonde as she was going out, a yawn was starting to decorate her face, her eyes still sleepy, she was starting to say good morning when another yawn got out, making Catra notice how tired her girlfriend was, maybe she didn't sleep good, or maybe it was the weight of the week finally hitting her or… but before Catra could keep up with her train of thoughts, Adora turned to her, a big smile illuminating, even more, her face.

When the blonde looked behind Catra, the brunette saw how her eyes were starting to fill with tears. Catra, being in Adora's life for so long, was used to this reaction from her girlfriend, Adora always cried when someone showed her unconditional affection, especially this day, it makes her even softer than she already was; this reaction was because after what her parents had done, she believed that you had to earn someone's love.

So she got closer to Adora to ask if she was alright, but before that happened, the blonde hugged her, whispering several and continuous thank you to her lover, Catra put her hands on Adora's back, so she could rub circles on it, trying to calm Adora. Sometimes the blonde could get so overwhelmed with emotions, making her feel a lot in so very little time, so Catra knew how to make it easier for her.

After some minutes later, Adora calmed down and grabbed by the hand, the couple went to sit down on their respective chairs, so they could start their breakfast, while they were eating, conversations about everything started to flow between them. That time, they usually used it to talk about school, catching up on that could be sometimes tedious, they being in different careers being the obstacle, but each other was excited about their partner. Catra considered that Adora's excited and happy face was a treasure that she would always keep close to her mind and heart.

When they finished eating, dishes went to the sink, ready to be cleaned another time, probably before any of their friends arrived.

Catra was eager to give Adora her gift, the letters were a special thing for both of them, in it, the brunette would pour everything she felt for her lover, sometimes a letter wasn’t enough to really express everything she feels for Adora and knew it was the same when she was on the receiving end. Catra sent Adora to sit on the couch while she was on her way to their room, to retrieve the letter.

Catra came back, a piece of paper in her hand, when Adora saw her she knew what it was. As the brunette came in front of the couch she stopped, sitting on the table positioned in front of her girlfriend, and extending her hand, Catra gave Adora her birthday letter. Catra was a little nervous, but that happens every year, Catra wanted the best for Adora and if she could give some of that in a letter, for Catra was enough, of course not including all the kisses, hugs, and their other many forms of affection.

Maybe to anyone else, it could be a meaningless piece of paper, but to them, it meant years and years of trust, love, dedication, and affection, to them those letters meant that no matter what happens they could always count on each other, a friendship, and a love like theirs it was special.

It was something you don't find so easily, a relationship so special that sometimes the two of them would wonder if they met in another life, but to them, the answer was there every day, they knew they were each other soulmates, and in all those letters was their love forever written.

They keep their letters in hidden places, Catra leaves them in a drawer in her childhood house, unlike her girlfriend, who has them in a bow under the bed in her room at Catra's house.

The reason Adora keeps her letters there it's because when she was a little kid and receive her second letter from Catra, she went and showed it to her mom, but she had been angry and little Adora didn't understand why, then her mom tried to take away her gift and Adora ran to her room and hid her letter, so her mom couldn't destroy it, so from then on, Adora kept all her letters

hidden until she was old enough to buy a box. Then put all the letters there and under her bed, they were more secure there than any other part of her house.

She took that habit with her when she moved to Catra's house, and it's not because she didn't trust her girlfriend, but she feared that something bad could happen to the letters.

Catra and Adora were everything to each other, they helped each other through everything that has happened, they were each other's support.

Life could break one apart, but the other would be there to help them rise again.

Life could be cruel to one, but the other would be there to show the infinite love there is out there.

Life can be whatever it wants to be, but they would be there for each other no matter what.

Around midday, Glimmer, and Bow arrived, they had a talk on the phone with the other half of the best friend squad to ask at what time to come over among other things. They agreed to have lunch at Adora’s house before starting to organize everything so in the evening could start the party.

When they knocked, Catra was the one to open the door, letting them in. The other half of the squad greeted Adora with hugs and cheek kisses to then start to sing Happy birthday, this time the blonde held back her tears, but Catra could still see them in her eyes, the brunette stayed at the door, watching how her girlfriend was being showered with affection, Catra treasured those moments, moments when the blonde received the love she deserved.

After lunch and some talks, the best friend squad began to decorate the backyard. Glimmer, as the organizer of everything, started the decorations, she had bought some balloons of every color, so they were scattered everywhere. She then told everyone what they had to do, Bow was serving every appetizer on plates, so they could be on a table outside, Catra was putting cute tablecloths on the tables Adora was bringing to the backyard, everything was looking good.

Adora was liking how everything was looking, she didn’t have experience at parties, but she had a good feeling about this one.

This birthday was going good, besides being surrounded by her best friends, Cyra and Elena had called her after she and Catra had been cuddling on the couch for at least half an hour, they had promised that they would go and tell her congratulations in person after the party or the day after, they wanted to Adora have her first birthday party.

Cyra and Elena loved Adora like she was their daughter, and Adora loved them like the parents she wished she had. Cyra, Elena, and Catra had taught her unconditional love, and she was grateful for having them in her life.

After some hours their friends started to arrive. The first people at the party were Scorpia and Perfuma. They had met when they entered college, a year later they became a couple. By their side was also Entrapta, they were a friend of Scorpia from high school.

Scorpia and Entrapta were the first friends Catra made besides Adora, don’t get her wrong Glimmer and Bow are also her friends, but they met Adora first.

Then Mermista and Sea Hawk arrived. Mermista would sometimes like to say that they weren't dating but everyone could see the affection they had for each other.

Lastly, Frosta arrived, she is a junior in high school, Perfuma met her at work, they had become friends pretty quickly, so Perfuma

introduced her to the group. All of them had become overprotective of Frosta given that she is the little one of the group, even though everyone knew she was capable of taking care of herself.

After some time, everyone was enjoying the party, Scorpia had entered the house for the cake and at that moment, Catra suddenly started to feel sick, and a bad thought came nagging into her mind telling her that something was about to happen, she sometimes felt like that and nothing really happened, so this time she decided to ignore it for the sake of Adora, this was one of the happiest days of her life, and Catra wasn't going to go and ruin it with bad imaginary superstitions.

Catra noticed the moment Scorpia was exiting the house, her expression was reflecting confusion and worry, her brows frowned, and her eyes directed at Adora, and at that moment, Catra felt like something had dropped in her stomach, she felt like someone was squishing her heart. Feeling protective of her girlfriend, Catra got close to Adora's side and grabbed her by the waist.

Scorpia got closer, and when she was in front of them, Catra knew that the bad feeling she started to feel moments ago was coming to reality, she was starting to regret the option of not telling Adora what she was feeling.

Scorpia cleared her throat to get Adora's attention, who was on Glimmer as they were talking about something. Adora turned to Scorpia, a big smile on her face. Catra noticed, for a while, the fun Adora was having, enjoying this day with people who really cared about you was amazing, in Adora's eyes there was a spark, that spark usually was reserved for Catra, Cyra, and Elena, but lately was also going out with their friends. Now, Catra feared that, whatever Scorpia was going to say, it would take away the spark that it took years to bring back.

"Adora, sorry to interrupt, but I heard some knocking at the door and when I opened some people were outside saying that they

came to see you, they also mentioned that they are your parents", before Scorpia finished, Catra turned her face to Adora and saw how her smile vanished, her face turned paler as the words left their friend's mouth and bad memories were coming to her mind.

Before Adora had the opportunity to talk, Catra said, "How did they look?"

"Well… the man has a beard and his eyes are gray, just like Adora and the woman has red hair which is weird because she doesn't look like Adora at all, that's why I came to tell you first besides you never talk about them, so I don't know how they look like… I'm going to shut up now", Scorpia finished, maybe now noticing the look Catra was giving her.

"Okay", Adora said quietly, almost like a whisper, before turning to Catra, "Can you call your moms please... they'll know what to do", Adora continued before turning and walking toward the house, but before she advanced too much, Catra grabbed her wrist stopping her abruptly.

Adora turned back to Catra, the brunette could see in her girlfriend's eyes the determination and curiosity, Adora hasn't seen her parents in almost four years. The last conversation they had ended in tears and Adora moving to Catra's house.

But as Catra looked more, she saw something in the blonde, that she hasn't seen in almost four years, and that was sadness. That was a feeling so bad to see in Adora, a feeling that has tormented her for so many years and Catra had promised herself all those years ago that she would do anything, so Adora wouldn't feel it again, at least in not the extreme where she would feel empty.

"Dor maybe I can come with you, just wait for me to call my mothers, and then we go", Catra said, hoping Adora wouldn't go alone, and Catra could protect her lover. The brunette didn't trust Randor and even less Marlena, they had hurt Adora so much, so she didn't imagine a good reason for them to visit their daughter, again after several years without contact.

“Don’t worry, I'll go by myself, it's going to be fine”, Adora’s voice coming stronger compared to seconds ago, as she said this Catra was confused, back then, when they were kids, Adora didn’t like to be alone with her parents, she always made an excuse to invite Catra to the house, or she would spend time at Catra’s house, sometimes she even signed up to extracurricular classes, all of that to spend less time at her house.

“Really?”, Catra asked, the incredulity in her voice was clear, but it was more of an instinct response than a thinking one, shook was going through her body, but when she had made that question, Adora had flinched, Catra tried to phrase her better her intentions, “Look, I won't take too long, it's going to be a quick call, then we’ll go”

“Catra, it’s really okay, I’ll go alone, it would be fine... I can take care of myself, I don't even know why you're insisting so much into coming", Adora’s voice at the end was coming softer, each sentence going quieter and quieter, but the hurt was also present, and in her eyes, Catra could see her determination, Adora wanted to know why her parents were in their house.

"I'm insisting because all those years ago, nothing was fine. Adora, they hurt you, a lot, and you didn't even tell me until we were seventeen. You barely got out of there, you let all that happen, but I was the one to help you, I was the one who was there picking up every single piece of you that they broke, and now they come as nothing happen, and you really think everything it's going to be okay when since the beginning they never were"

Catra said it before she could think it, she didn't process it, she just let everything out, Catra was furious but scared that something awful would happen to Adora, not noticing what she just said.

Adora took a step back, the grip on Adora’s wrist was loose, allowing her to take her hand back, the blonde’s eyes were being quickly filled with tears, and in her face betrayal was clearly

reflected. That moment made Catra realized what she just said, Catra felt sick, her throat was closing and in her heart felt like someone was squeezing it hard.

"I let...", Adora was breathing hard, her chest going up and down each time more quickly, the sadness in her was still there, but another emotion was starting to rise. She needed to be numb, to face her parents, and to try and not show how she really was feeling, she needed to show the numbness that was always kept in a box and surprisingly goes out when she needs to protect herself from more hurt.

“Adora I- ”, Catra tried to say, but Adora interrupted her, a hand shut up, showing Catra her palm, her eyes focused on other points, but never on Catra

“Don’t… just call your moms”, Adora’s voice coming cold and stern out of her mouth, making Catra flinch; they have never talk like that to each other, so hearing that tone on Adora and towards Catra, was like someone was stabbing her heart, it hurt.

Adora took another step back before turning completely, giving Catra just the sight of her back, and walked towards the house, her hand close, forming a fist, the brunette knew this was a habit Adora did when she was trying to stop the tears from being released, Catra at that moment felt even worse than before, knowing she was the one who caused her partner’s tears.

Catra was dragging her hand on her face when she heard Glimmer, a very angry Glimmer, “What the hell was that?”, every single one of her friends had mixed feelings on their faces, some were mad, maybe at Catra, some were sad, trying to give an innocent explanation as to what Catra said, but everyone was curious, Adora didn't like to share a lot about her past, but everyone let it slide, thinking it wasn't that important, oh how wrong were all of them

“Look... I’ll explain later, first I have to call my moms”, before Glimmer or anyone else could say something, Catra grabbed her

phone off her pocket and immediately called one of her moms

Her phone ringed two times before her mom Cyra with a sweet voice answered

"Hi, baby"

"Hi mom", Catra answered trying to hold back tears

"It's everything alright?", Cyra said, "You sound a bit off, it's Adora alright?"

"No, Marlena and Randor are in the house talking to Adora, she said that I should call you"

"Oh, okay, I let your mama know, then we will on our way there, Love you"

"Love you too mom, and tell mama that I love her too"

"Of course, Bye"

"Bye", Catra ended the call and turn to her friends, most of them were clearly preoccupied for Adora, while Glimmer still was mad at Catra

"Look, I know you're mad at me, and with every right, I shouldn't have said that, I was just nervous for Adora", Catra said to Glimmer, to then turn to all her friends and explain, " I can't tell you everything because it's Adora story to tell not mine, what I can tell you, is that she'll need our love and support, always", Catra said knowing everyone was still very curious about Adora's parents and why she said what she said. Glimmer looked less mad, but mad nonetheless, her eyebrows frown, and in her eyes were a spark of recognition.

"Hey, she'll be fine, she is one of the strongest people I know, besides she has all of us to look out for her" As Bow finished saying, all of their friends nodding agreeing with him, maybe they didn't understand all that has happened and the situation, but

they were loyal, and even if they have just met a year ago, they had demonstrated to be loving and devoted to the people they love.

Catra looks at the house and nods before saying, “Yeah, you’re right”, Catra didn’t know if this confirmation was to assure her friends that Adora was going to be fine or was to assure herself

Now the only thing to do was wait for her moms to arrive and be there for Adora.

Chapter End Notes

> So... I end it with a half cliffhanger, I'm so excited because this it's the first story I write with multiple chapters, so please comment and let me know what you thought of this chapter, what do you think it will happen after or you can give more ideas to write, anything it's appreciated.
>
> Have a great day, night or week! :)

A woman looks

Chapter Summary

Fights and feelings, we learn a little bit more about Adora's past.

Chapter Notes

Hi, I came back with another chapter, it's not as extent as the past one but I hope you like it :)

TW: slightly mention of violence

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Find out the cause of this effect,

Or rather say, the cause of this defect,

For this effect defective comes by cause.

William Shakespeare, Hamlet (1600-02), Act II, scene 2, line 10

Catra was desperate, it has been almost an hour since Adora went to see her parents. Randor and Marlena were never good news, and even if it was Marlena the primary factor of Adora's complicated past, Randor isn't innocent, he never defended his daughter or stood up for her.

She didn't know if her girlfriend was alright or if her mothers had arrived. Everyone was having conversations, but the ambient still felt tense. Their friends wanted to know Adora's past, now more than before, after Catra and Adora's fight, but they still wanted to respect her privacy, so they didn't ask Catra, they just wanted to make sure Adora was alright.

The brunette didn't want to participate in any talk, her mind was a thousand miles away, thinking on many options as to how she

could apologize to her girlfriend for her words. She knew that what she had said was a mistake, but sometimes her feelings were too much that they tended to burst, they needed a way out, the downside was that sometimes her words were directed at a person who didn't deserve it.

Catra's heart gave several hard blows against her chest, feeling like it could go out of her at any second. The moment her mothers were exiting her house, they were holding each other's hand, but next to them, it wasn't Adora, her anxious state just going worse, her mind going crazy thinking the worst scenario as to why Adora wasn't there, had she gone with her parents?, had she gone to another place because she was mad with Catra?

So many questions roaming inside her head, and she knew that she wouldn't like the answers if Adora really left, but before her mind went even further into a spiral, she noticed the look her mom was giving her, Cyra's look most of the time was kind, showing her great heart, but that look can also be just as furious, and that look was the only proof Catra needed to know she was in big trouble.

"Catarina Elizabeth Diaz", the brunette heard her full name, it was being said with anger, but also worry. Two thoughts came into Catra's mind; one, Adora was fine, or as fine as you can be after a visit of people like Marlena, her mothers would have told her immediately if Adora wasn't okay, and thought number two, it's that she knew her mom would just scold her, her voice had the tone she used on Catra when she was a kid doing trouble around the neighborhood.

Before Cyra could say another word, Elena put a hand against Cyra's chest, her hand was gently above her partner's heart, a gesture so delicate.

Her mama interrupted her, "Love, let me ask my thing first, then you can talk to her, okay?", after a nod of confirmation from Cyra, Elena continued this time looking directly at Catra, she gave her a tiny smile, "Baby, where is your emergency kit?", Catra looked

scared now, Elena noticed so try to reassure her that Adora was fine, she put her hands now on Catra's shoulders, “Hey, before you panic even more, she is fine, I’ll explain everything later, but first I need to know where it is so I can help her?”

“It’s in the bathroom, in the cabinet”, Elena just nodded and headed inside, not before giving another smile to Catra.

Catra was still watching her mama go to the house when she heard a throat being cleared, when she turned, Cyra was still looking at her, a glare in her eyes, showing how mad she was, “Want to explain to me why you said that to Adora?”

"You know?", Catra asked feeling the look of her friends on her back, she wanted to keep her conversation private but knew her mother would do it outside, not wanting to disturb Adora.

"Yes, she told me, after Marlena and Randor left, I asked her why you weren't outside with her, and she explained everything, well only her part, now I want to know yours", her mom answered, her look was each moment less angry and more understanding, but in her eyes, the question was still hanging "Why?"

Catra took some time to respond, her mind racing, her heart felt like it would go out of her chest at any moment. On her, she could feel her mom's eyes, waiting for an answer, with a sigh, Catra responded, “Honestly, I was scared for her and angry at Marlena. Adora has been through enough, and Marlena appearing again isn't a good scenario”, Catra decided it was best to answer with truth since the beginning, there wasn’t a point in lies and less to her mother and even more about Adora.

“Being scared or angry doesn’t justify the words we say to other people, more if those words hurts them”, her mom told her, knowing Catra's tendencies, and Cyra just like Catra was worried about Adora.

“I know, Okay”, I sigh, “I will apologize to her for the rest of my life if it’s necessary, but you have to understand my point of view

too. I was scared that they would say or do something that could hurt her and I know that in the end, it was my words that hurt her".

Catra takes a breath trying to get rid of the tears that are forming in her eyes to say the next, knowing that if she doesn't, she wouldn't stop crying, and won't be able to finish what she wants to say

"Mom, you and I were there since everything started, you and I were there every time she came crying into our doorstep asking if she could stay the rest of the night with us, you and I were there when everything with her...", Catra stops, she knows she can reveal a lot about that time, it's Adora's and Adora's only to tell, she looks at her friends, then back to Cyra.

"Mom, when she was seventeen she lost her light, she lost hope, she lost herself trying to make her mother happy. We lost… I lost my Adora to a woman who don't deserve her, and now she was getting back to her old self with our help, and with our friend's help, but I was afraid that I would lose her again and that this time she isn't going to come back"

Catra let go of everything that she didn't allow herself to say to anyone before. Adora is the love of her life, and she saw her in each facet of her life, knowing how good but also how bad can things go, she felt now with that confession, how her tears run freely in her cheeks, dampening her t-shirt.

"Oh, baby", her mother just said before hugging her and holding her tight. Catra accepted the hug and returned with the same fierce love her mother was pouring into the embrace.

"This might be scary for you, but it is for me too, and you know that you'll always have our support in everything. Don't worry, our Adora, it's going to be fine, we are going to shower her with love as we have always done, she is going to be the same optimistic, heart of gold and happy Adora we have always known", her mom

whispered in her ear, knowing she needed the words to motivate her to keep strong for her girlfriend.

When they parted, her mom grabbed her by the shoulders, and gave her a kiss on her forehead, just like when she was a kid and needed to feel supported.

“Alright, I’m going to check on Adora and Elena, I’ll see you inside and you better apologize to her”, and with a last look, her mom went to the house.

Catra felt how all the tension that was in her shoulders leaving, and with a sigh, she turned to face her friends just realizing she said some private things about Adora that they clearly didn’t know. It was shown in their shocked faces, some of them with tears. Catra took several steps to stay in front of them and cleaned the tears that remained in her cheeks, before putting on a serious face and started saying, “I know you heard some things, but please don’t mention anything to Adora until she is ready to talk about that, please, those were hard times for her, and I would really appreciate if this talk stayed between us."

After several nods, some of her friends started to say goodbye, giving her and Adora privacy, Scorpia, as expected, said goodbye by giving her a big hug. Everyone understood that Adora needed time and space, so they told Catra that they would call her just to know how Adora was doing, in case the blonde wasn't up to answer her phone.

Catra entered the house Bow and Glimmer just some steps behind her, they wanted to stay and check up on Adora. Catra noticed Cyra in the kitchen serving a glass of water, "Where are mama and Adora?", she asked as soon Cyra turned her head.

"Your mama took Adora to your bedroom, so she could lay down and maybe try to sleep. Adora said she was tired"

Catra was nodding when she turned her head to the rest of the best friend squad, she noticed how Bow was trying to stop his

tears, and Glimmer had a comforting arm around her boyfriend's shoulders

"Hey, Adora would be fine, she is one of the strongest persons I know, besides she has us, we will be by her side any time she needs it", Glimmer said as she realized that Catra was looking at them.

Some minutes later, Catra turned her head to the stairs when she heard the floor creaking, and as expected it was Elena coming down. Before Catra had the chance to open her mouth, her mama said, "Adora is asleep, and before you ask, she is fine, well as fine as you can be with what happened".

After hearing this Catra knew that Adora would make it seem as she was fine, Adora tended to help other people when they needed her but often neglected the idea that sometimes she needed help too, she would often see herself as some person whose purpose was to take care and make everyone around her happy, but she would forget that she needed care too, and Catra, she was the person who reminded Adora that she was just as important as everyone else, that she was worth taking care of, that she was enough.

"Why did you ask me where the emergency kit was?", Catra finished asking as a frown was forming on her forehead, her mama answered as she was getting close to Catra, "I asked for the emergency kit because... Adora has a cut on her cheek from where Marlena slapped her"

"She did what?", Catra raised her voice without noticing, and it's not like she could help it. Marlena was a bad mother, she did awful things to Adora, but she had never raised a hand to Adora, she never got to that extreme.

“We weren’t expecting it either, after we saw what she did, we told her to never contact Adora ever again”, Cyra finished explaining what had happened, in her face, Catra could see that her mom was also mad for what Marlena did, they, just like Catra

had known Adora since she was a baby, they saw her grow up, to them Adora was another member of their family.

After talking about the arrangement of rooms with her friends and mothers, Catra decided it was time to go and check up on Adora, so she said her goodbyes and went up the stairs, when she arrived at her door she paused, she knew Adora probably was still upset with her, but her mama had said Adora was asleep so entering her bedroom was a risk she was going to take.

Opening her door as quietly as possible, Catra entered her room, as her eyes were adjusting to the lack of light, she heard the soft snores she was accustomed to hearing every night.

When she could see, the first thing her eyes saw was a silhouette in her bed, Adora's body was facing her right, their blanket reached her neck.

Catra walked to their closet to grab her sleepwear and went to their bedroom to change, as she was brushing her teeth she saw herself in the mirror and flinched, her reflection showing her red eyes, she almost never cried, and if she did, she would do it with no one around her, but this occasion Catra decided that none of that matter, she had to let everything out before helping Adora, besides that, her mothers always told her that it's not bad to show emotion, she just likes to show everyone else that she was strong, an aspect that she shared with Adora, the difference between them was that Catra acknowledges that there was nothing wrong in showing when you were vulnerable and needed someone else to be the strong figure while Adora saw herself as the savior of everybody.

Catra was walking toward her bed when Adora turned around, now facing Catra. She stopped waiting to see if Adora was still asleep, and when she didn't move, Catra continued until she lay down in her bed, facing Adora.

As they were facing each other, Catra could see Adora's face better, in her eyes she could still see the remains of Adora's tears,

below her right eye, in her cheek was a tiny cut, and surrounding it was a red mark slowly turning purple. Catra slowly was moving her hand to touch Adora's cut, but she stopped not wanting to disturb her lover.

Catra's mind was thinking about a lot at the same time, and to say she was overwhelmed was an understatement, she was thinking how could she make it up to Adora, so she could forgive her, she was also thinking why Marlena thought it was a good idea to come to her daughter's house on her birthday just to torment her and why Randor didn't do anything, and the last of the important thoughts in her head was how Adora it's going to be affected after all that has happened.

Before she could analyze everything again she saw the clock in her nightstand and decided it was better to sleep, so she could try and resolve everything in the morning.

They were slowly getting closer, when Catra felt the contact of a leg against hers, she noticed that it wasn't skin against skin as almost always has been, instead the skin of Adora's leg was covered with soft texture, it was sweatpants, Catra noticed. The blonde's upper body was also covered, it was with a long-sleeved shirt.

Most of the time, Adora, for when they went to sleep or to be in the house just the two of them, wore clothes that had a lot of skin revealed, she likes the feeling of Catra's skin against hers, which brought comfort to her, but when she was younger she used long clothes, so she could hide her body, feeling so insecure about it, didn't want anyone to notice her, sometimes that type of clothing it was the one to bring her comfort.

Catra remembered all those past times, Adora sometimes didn't like to rely on other people, thinking she could be a burden to that person, Catra knows how bad Adora's thoughts can get, and to be the one not providing that security brought pain in her heart. Adora needed that comfort, needed that security, but at this moment, it was in her clothes and not in her partner.

When Catra was closing her eyes, she felt an arm go around her waist until the hand was placed in her shoulder blades. Catra smiled before getting close to the body and placing her arm on Adora’s shoulders, her partner's head in her chest, surely hearing her heartbeat.

Catra placed a kiss in Adora’s head, simultaneously whispering an “I love you, I'll make it up to you, I promise”, before she fell asleep, content to be in her lover’s arms.

Chapter End Notes

I have to address a lot of stuff, first in my imagination, Catra it's Latin, I can't decide if she is Mexican, Puerto Rican or Cuban, but in this story Cyra, Elena and Catra used to speak spanish in their house all the time, causing Adora to learn it, it not really relevant in the story but it's fact on this story

Second, so... I couldn't publish the chapter before because a lot of stuff it's happening and I feel so overwhelmed. School has been kicking my ass and my mental health it isn't in a right place at the moment. I will try to publish the next one as soon as possible.

And to all the people who like this story, thanks for supporting me, your kudos and comments are the ones who make my days better

Have a great day, night and week. :)

Or a man tells lies

Chapter Summary

An awkward breakfast and a heartbreaking conversation

TW: Slightly mention of homophobia, eating disorder, so read at your own choice

Chapter Notes

Hi!!!! I'm back with another chapter, it's shorter than previous ones but I was having a slight writer's block but I'm back, and I will try to update more frequently.

TW: Slightly mention of homophobia, eating disorder, so read at your own choice, if you don't want to read it, I will put a summary on the notes of the end, to me the scenes are strong but not because of the actions it's because of the words said, so please remember to proceed with caution.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The strongest principle of growth lies in human choice.

George Eliot, Daniel Deronda (1876), Book VI, Chapter XLII.

The next morning, Catra was the first one to wake up, the sun illuminating her face, she had forgotten to close the curtains the night before. She felt Adora's head buried in her neck and soft puffs of air in her collarbone, the brunette closed her eyes to stay a little more time in the comfort of her lover's arms but decided to fully wake up to prepare breakfast and plan what to do so she could ask for forgiveness to Adora the right way, she said some

things that shouldn’t have been mentioned, but there was no turning back.

Walking down the stairs, she started to repeat the events of last night, the words that came out of her mouth were roaming in her head, those words that had hurt Adora, Catra had always made everything so Adora could be happy, but, sometimes things got out of control, she recognized that what she did was wrong, but fear was reigning her body and mind, she was acting on her feelings, who could really blame her.

Her thoughts came to an abrupt stop when she heard some voices coming from the kitchen and remembered that her moms and two of her best friend were staying in her house.

When Catra entered the kitchen she noticed her mom, Cyra was finishing preparing breakfast, out of the two, preferred to cook, on her left beside the stove were some plates with eggs and toast bread, while her mama was helping by cutting some fruit.

By the left, Bow and Glimmer were sitting on stools, as she got closer to the kitchen, she said good morning, her visitant responded back, all of them in different tones.

Catra went to help her moms when she felt a pair of eyes to her, turning her head toward Glimmer and Bow, she noted that the couple was looking at her, Bow had worry and curiosity on his face while Glimmer was still mad at Catra. The brunette just raised an eyebrow toward her friends but before any of them could manage a word, everyone heard how the door of the bedroom was being open.

Everyone turned their looks to Adora, who had her eyes fixated on the floor, she didn’t notice the looks she was receiving, to consume in her own mind to pay attention to the rest.

When Adora raised her head, she notices the looks, she watched them, and when her eyes landed on Catra, the blonde quickly

advertised her eyes to watch somewhere else, the eye contact between the couple had lasted just seconds.

Catra felt a pang on her chest when this happened, she knew that what occurred yesterday was a lot and that she did wrong, but she really didn’t expect that Adora wouldn’t look at her. Catra saw how Adora started to bite the inside of her lips and cheeks, the blonde did that when she was nervous.

The silence that was on the house was stretching even more each second that passed in time until Cyra decided to talk, “Breakfast is ready, why doesn’t everyone go to sit while Catra and I bring everything to the table”, then she gave a nod to Elena, communicating between them.

After they were sited, everyone started to engage in an awkward conversation, just to relieve the heavy silence, everyone except Catra and Adora, they were just looking at each other and then advertise their look, like they wanted to look at their partner but didn't want to get caught doing that, in their faces were reflected their thoughts, they wanted to talk to each other but didn’t know what to say.

The breakfast keep going like that until it was too much, Cyra decided that it was better to leave them alone, so she took her plate along with Elena, Glimmer and Bow, and took them to the sink, they said their goodbyes and left the tensioned house. This issue was was between them and Cyra knew that if they didn't leave, the girls wouldn't talk to each other, not until they were alone.

Adora went to sit on the couch, still not looking and talking to Catra. The brunette felt her heart in the throat, her stomach still felt in a knot, she was worried, she didn’t know what her girlfriend was thinking or how she was feeling, communication was a big part of the relationship, that's how they kept it healthy, and not talking was killing Catra.

Catra wanted to give Adora space, but she also needed to know what she could do to amend what she said. Adora was still looking at the floor when Catra decided to sit on the couch next to her, but still having centimeters separate them.

The brunette turned to look at her partner, she started by the face, she could see that any emotion was showing in those gray-blue eyes of her, it was like if there were void, then she lowered her eyes, Adora's mouth was slightly moving, she was biting her cheeks again, then lowered her eyes again, her girlfriend's hands were shaking but not too noticeable, and lastly, her left leg was going up and down, she needed to move. Adora was known for her movement, she couldn't stay still for too long.

Catra recognized all those little movements as Adora being nervous, maybe even anxious, so the brunette decided that she was going to start to talk, give the first step to fix the situation.

"Want to talk about what happened?" Catra asked, not sure if Adora would answer

Some minutes passed, and Catra was sure that Adora would not talk, but then she nodded, still looking at the floor before starting, "I stopped at the door just to give myself time to process seeing my parents again when I opened the door… they were actually there, in front of me", Adora sighed before she continued, "My dad smiled at me and a little spark of hope ignited in my heart, you know I thought... that maybe they were there to apologize for everything and make amends… maybe finally I could have my parents, the parents I wanted for so long, but then I looked at my mother and - and that spark died just as fast as it ignited"

Some tears were starting to form in Adora's eyes before starting to flow through her cheeks, Catra wanted to brush them away, but she also wanted to give Adora the space she needed, her phrases were going slowly as if she didn't want to relieve that again.

Adora continued, “My mother looked at me like… like I was something disgusting like she didn’t recognize me like she didn’t want to see me again, and then I understood... visiting me was my dad’s idea. I don’t even know how they knew where I live”.

Catra saw how the blonde’s hands were shaking more, her eyes had turned sad, her cheeks still had tears running, and her look was still planted on the floor, Catra saw Adora take a deep breath before continuing

“ My mother started to question why I didn’t change my preference instead of weight, she said how could I live with myself knowing I like people I shouldn't like and a lot of awful things. I swear that my heart kept on breaking, I really hoped that my parents had accepted me but they didn't, they came to judge…”, then in an even quiet voice she added, “They didn’t even say Happy birthday”

“My mother kept on talking until your mothers arrived, Cyra told my parents to leave, and my mother responded that they were a bad influence on me, they were the cause for her daughter to a lost cause, that it's where I lost it, I talked back to my mother, I told her how bad of a parent she was and she slapped me, one of her rings cut my cheek and I think that was the last straw for my dad because he took her wrist and got her up in the car, driving away probably to their house. I felt a million emotions at the same time, seeing my parents again after almost three years confused me, and now I don't know what to feel, what to do.”

“And I made it even worse”, Catra said in a quiet voice almost like a whisper, several emotions were swimming in her chest, but the one who as more predominant was guilt, she said things to Adora that she shouldn’t have, Adora had confided on her, and she just spilled it out to stop her from seeing the people who hurt her, and in the end the one who hurt Adora more was her.

“Maybe… I don't know if you did it worse or not, what I know it’s that you really hurt me”, finally Adora looked at Catra, their eyes were locked, Adora's eyes reflected sadness and betrayal, “I didn’t

expect those words from you… You who always had been there for me, you who helped me when my parents threw me out of the house, you, my girlfriend, my best friend and my soulmate", at the end Adora's voice broke, a lot has happened in her life and in her eyes, Catra could see all the suffering she had to endure.

Three years ago Adora left her house, and with the help of Catra and her mothers, she was slowly getting better, she was eating more, not flinching if someone raised their voice, learning to love herself more, not apologizing for everything. She had come a long way with Catra's help, but, what she said really hurt Adora, so the trust they had built over the years was going to be built again, and Catra was going to make sure to do everything right this time.

"I know this doesn't compensate for anything, but I'm really sorry for what I said. I was scared because I've seen what they did to you, and I didn't want you to go back to that, but my way of expressing that wasn't correct, I shouldn't have said that, and I really hope you forgive me", Catra said, looking directly at Adora's eyes, so she could see how honest she was being, Adora just nodded but didn't say anything until minutes later.

"I… I have to think about it, what you said really hit deep, and as much as it pains me, I think... we need space... I need space..."

Catra tried to hold back tears but knew what she had to do, she sighed before speaking, "Okay... I'll go and pack some stuff, call me or text when you're ready"

Catra stood up from the couch on her way to their room, she knew she screwed up, and if a way for Adora to forgive her was giving her space then that's what Catra is going to do. She didn't expect that outcome and it wasn't like Adora was breaking up with her, the blonde just needed time and space to organize her thoughts and feelings.

Grabbing a suitcase, Catra began to fill it with clothes and other essentials, her own feelings were a mess, maybe this was the best for both of them, she felt a hole in the deep bottom of her

stomach, her throat was closed, and her eyes were full of tears that had not fallen.

When she exited the room and continued on walking making her way through the house, she stopped in the living room when she saw Adora, the blonde was now sited on another sofa, closer to the lateral window, the front part of her body was towards the window, her face was blank, she didn’t turn around when Catra got out of their room.

The brunette made her way to the door, grabbing her keys, she opened the door and stood up in the doorway, she turned toward Adora and said, “Goodbye... I - if you need anything call me or my moms”

Adora kept on looking outside through the window, and Catra exited the house, pulling her stuff in the trunk, Catra got in the car and went to her mothers' house, the twisted feeling in her stomach wasn’t going away nor the pressure in her heart, her tears were more than ready to go out, but she wasn't.

They were drifting apart, and Catra didn’t know what she was going to do if she didn't have Adora in her life, they have known each other since they were toddlers. They were each other's everything.

At that moment Catra realized that a mistake can break people away, a mistake can take away the person you care about the most.

Chapter End Notes

*Summary: Catra wakes up and decided to prepare breakfast but remembers that her moms and best friends are in her house, then everyone tough that they could have a normal breakfast but it doesn't go as planned, so everyone leaves our couple so they could discuss things. Adora tells Catra what happened with her parents, and when Catra decides to

apologize, Adora ask her for time, Catra leaves the house and goes with her mothers.

*So if you did read the hole thing and felt identified or someone has told you things like that, I just want to tell you, that you are beautiful and enough, they don't know what it's best for you, that it's something that only you know. If anyone need to talk you can message me, I know what it feels when people you care bout doesn't care the same way about you.

*Every comment and kudos brights my day and keep me writing, so thank you to everyone who has left a comment and kudos :)

*Follow me on Twitter you can find me as Sof/Writer & Reader or as @reader_sof, you can DM there too.

Have a great day, night and week :)

And the pleasant brooks

Chapter Summary

A flashback come to mind, and the origins of the house reveals

Chapter Notes

Hi, I'm back with another chapter, as the summary says we get to see a flashback on Catra and Adora's life and where do they get the house they're living in.

So, I wanted to update this chapter sooner, but I felt like some things were still missing on the chapter so I stayed editing, but here it is. I hope you'll like it! :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"The sea did what it liked, and what it liked was destruction. It thundered at the town, and thundered at the cliffs, and brought the coast down, madly" - A tale of two cities, Charles Dickens

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Catra was laying down on her bed, her eyes facing the ceiling, the clock in her nightstand at her left was marking that it was a little past midnight, she wasn't to worry about her sleep schedule, tomorrow was Saturday so that meant she didn't have to wake up early, she was making plans to go out with Adora, in her hands was her phone, she was still waiting for Adora's text.

They always called or text each other before falling asleep, only that this time, Adora stopped replying to her texts suddenly and Catra was getting anxious each minute that was passing.

Her girlfriend wasn't the type of person who stopped replying abruptly and less at this hour. If she somehow got busy she would

say it, so the other person would know why she wasn’t replying, but this time she didn’t answer any of the five texts that Catra sent more than half an hour ago.

Catra didn't want to look desperate by sending more texts, but she was worried about Adora, her house wasn't the nicest to live in. It wasn't about the neighborhood, that was actually good, the houses were massive, two and sometimes three floors, they had an immense height, in front of them was an extended yard. Adora's house was white with touches of blue on the door and in some decor outside, in the inside professional paintings were hang. All of that was nice, but the bad part of the house was their inhabitants, more specifically Marlena.

She would always find an excuse to tell Adora that everything she does it's wrong, some other times Marlena would tell Adora that she isn't enough or that nobody would want her if she wasn't useful. Catra found out about everything when they were 12, Adora had come to her house with red eyes, and had let out everything, from that moment Catra promised herself and to Adora that she would do anything in her power to always help Adora, no matter what.

An unexpected knock on the door downstairs caused Catra to bolt out of her bed, her heart in her throat, she had a bad feeling. She was walking down the stairs hoping that the one who was knocking was Adora, because if she wasn’t, Catra would go mad, Adora doesn’t disappear unexpectedly and without telling Catra, because, at the end of the day, they were each other’s confidants, besides this wouldn’t be the first night that Adora arrives at her house in the middle of the night.

As Catra was going out of her room she notices that her mothers were also exiting their room, they heard the door too, they know about Adora's situation, and they have been supporting and helping her. While they were going down the stair behind Catra, they started to wonder who would be knocking at this hour.

When Cyra opens the door, Catra's heart drops. Adora, it’s standing in their doorway with several backpacks and a suitcase by her side, the moonlight behind her illuminates her body, the blonde looks pale, Catra doesn't know if it's because of the light or the reason she was in her house, her hands were slightly shaking, tears still flowing out of her gray-blue eyes.

Eyes that looked empty, sad, and destroyed

Adora looked at Catra first, then looked at Elena later, and in the end at Cyra, “Can I stay here, just till I find another place”, Catra noticed that her voice came raspy as she just screamed for hours, but it also came shaky like she was scared.

Cyra let her pass through the door, she surrounded Adora's shoulders and lead her in so she could sit on the couch, Catra was still in shock, trying to understand why her best friend was in that state and what was the reason this time she appeared at her door in the middle of the night without letting her know before, and why was she asking for a place to stay.

Catra could feel her head and body act again as she heard a noise in the kitchen, probably it was her mama making something for Adora to drink or eat.

Catra sat beside Adora taking her left hand in both of hers, she looked directly at Adora’s eyes, started to examine her body, Adora looked skinnier and pale, like she hasn't eaten in days, and that was worrying Catra.

The brunette looked at her best friend's eyes again, their looks were connected, gray-blue eyes against the amber and blue eyes of Catra, with her eyes, Catra was trying to let her girlfriend know that she was there for everything she needed, that Catra and her family would be by her side no matter what, and Catra believes that worked because she received a tiny smile, before Adora's attention turned to the floor.

Cyra sited on the other side of Adora. Elena came back from the kitchen, she brought a cup of hot chocolate, Adora's favorite, and she put it on the table in front of the couch, after that she sat on the sofa next to them.

Cyra was the first to talk, she put a hand on Adora's back and started to rub her shoulder blades, making Adora look from the floor to Cyra, "What happened? Are you okay?", asked Cyra with urgency in her voice trying also to understand the situation, Adora was like a daughter to Cyra and Elena, they knew what bad excuse of parents Adora had, they wanted to help her.

"My parents kicked me out", Adora answered after some seconds of silence, her lips were quivering, so she started to bite her lower lip, as she was trying to hold back more tears, "They found out I'm a lesbian, I don't know who told them, but then I decided to tell them that what they heard was the truth, and my mother exploded, she told me that I was a disgrace, that I was going for a wrong path, that I didn't know what I was talking about, and a lot of others things that I don't have the strength to repeat", as she was finishing, Adora's tears were back on her eyes and cheeks, after hearing this, Cyra just hugged Adora and kissed her on her head, whispering words of reassurance and love

Cyra grabbed Adora's shoulders, so they were facing again, and told her, "You can stay here the time you need and want, we love you, Adora, just as you are, okay, never forget that we will be by your side always supporting you" and Cyra brought Adora again in a tighter hug as Adora's tears continued to flow.

After some time, sleep and exhaustion were getting everybody, so they decided it was time to go to bed. Catra was at Adora's side as they were walking the stairs, it was a little uncomfortable because neither of them wanted to separate but they didn't mind.

As they were entering Catra's room Cyra stopped them and sent Adora to go and change her clothes, so she could sleep better, when the blonde entered the bathroom Cyra talked to Catra, "Tomorrow your mama and I will go to Adora's house and collect

the rest of her stuff, take care of her, okay baby, she needs us now more than ever”

“I know, I’ll take care of her, always and forever”

Cyra just smiled and gave her a hug and kiss on the forehead, and when Adora exited the bathroom, Cyra did the same to her, Elena not far behind, gave them a kiss on the temple to both of them. They left the young couple alone, saying good night.

As soon as Catra and Adora fell into the bed they embraced each other,
Catra hugged Adora with all her strength, whispering in her ear that everything was going to be fine. The brunette was curious, she wanted to know what had happened exactly, what Randor didn't try to stop Adora from leaving, who told Adora's parents about it, so many questions that Catra knew, Adora wasn't ready to answer, because even after all, Adora loved her parents.

Catra knows Adora needs her, needs someone to support her, needs someone to love her, she just needs someone.

Adora and Catra fell asleep embraced, their bodies, hearts, and souls connected.

They had each other, and for tonight, that was enough.

Leaving the house where she was living with Adora was painful, they have been living there for at least two years. Just after they turned 18, Mara, Adora's aunt gave them the house when she found out what her sister in law had done.

Adora was like a daughter to Mara, they were so similar that everyone could believe they were mother and daughter, the only difference was their hair where Adora had blonde hair, nobody knew from who she got it, Mara, on the other hand, had brown hair; besides that, they were the same, from eyes to height and even to attitude.

The only reason for them to not live together after the incident was because Mara lived in another country, but she called or texted Adora daily, she sometimes visited, just to see how she is doing.

This house held a lot of memories for Adora, it was a special place, so when her aunt said that Adora and Catra were the new owners of the house, Catra was excited, they were forming new memories in a place Adora' held close to her heart.

Leaving a place that to Catra was becoming home was heartbreaking, she knew that Adora needed time, but this felt awfully like a break-up, Catra was leaving a place where nice memories existed, a place where her heart was.

Their home was a place that reminded Catra, of Adora, it was safe and warm, like Adora's arms, it was pleasant, like all her moments with Adora, their home was dreamy, like Adora's kisses, so yeah, leaving that place was agonizing.

On her way to her mother's place, Catra's heart felt like it was breaking in a million parts, her chest felt like something was pressing on it, she wanted to arrive at her childhood house and cry in her mama's arms, Cyra and Elena gave the best hugs, of course not including Scorpia and Adora, they were Catra's second safe place.

This time apart Adora was going to be difficult.

Catra was at their usual lunch table, waiting for Bow and Glimmer, it has been two months since Adora and her went on a break, Catra has been living with her mothers, they received her with open arms, knowing the difficult situation, Catra and Adora meant a lot to each other, but Adora needed time, and everyone was going to respect that.

That doesn't mean Catra isn't worried, she doesn't know how Adora has been, nobody knows about her. Glimmer and Bow

visited her the day after Catra left, but Adora never opened the door, they tried to call her, and she never answered.

They, like Catra, decided to give her space, that what's she needed, but all that time apart just brought sadness into Catra’s life, she misses her girlfriend, being separated of her was a concept Catra still was coming to terms with, they have always been in each other's life. All this time alone has been bringing memories of them, some good and happy and others with so much sadness on them, she just hoped that Adora talked to her and gave her another chance, she hoped that Adora could forgive her.

One of the memories that repetitively was playing in her mind, was the time Adora moved in with her. That day Adora looked so broken, but Catra didn’t mind picking every single piece to put her back together. After months in her house, the blonde started to smile more, being more confident about herself, not questioning if she did bad or not, she was getting better, and now Catra was afraid that Adora was going to fall into those bad habits again.

And if she did, Catra couldn’t bear the thought to know that she was part of that, she wanted just to protect her, and she hoped she could do it in the future.

Catra was brought out of her head when Glimmer and Bow came to the table, they were talking about some class, Catra wasn’t really paying attention, a part of her mind was still on Adora, her friends noticed this and tried to distract her, it worked but not that much.

At the end of the day, Adora was one of the most important people in her life, and trying to get her out of her mind would be a waste of time.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you liked this chapter, I'm still finishing writing some things so maybe the next updates will take more time to

update.

If you like it, don't hesitate to leave a comment or kudos, those always brighten my day.

I hope you have a great day, night and week! :)

And the quiet skies

Chapter Summary

An importan phone call interrupts Catra's daily rutine, would it be the call she has been expecting?

Chapter Notes

Hi!!! Sorry for not updating before but here you have a new chapter, this is actually longer than the one I was going to update originally, thank you for still reading this story and thank you for waiting for this update, happy reading :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Know then, whatever cheerful and serene
Supports the mind, supports the body too:
Hence, the most vital movement mortals feel
Is hope, the balm and lifeblood of the soul.

John Armstrong, Art of Preserving Health (1744), Book IV, line 310

It has been almost three months since Adora has talked to Catra, or to anyone. The brunette didn't know with whom to talk, the anguish, fear and worry were consuming her from inside, her girlfriend was isolating herself.

The first month without communication with Adora had everyone a little preoccupied, but not too much, they decided the space was good for the blonde, the second month the worries and anguish were escalating, even if all of them don't know each other for very long they came to care a lot about everyone, so they started to ask Glimmer, Bow, and Catra if they knew anything about Adora, but this third month they went from asking their friends to directly

call or message Adora, but as previous times, the blonde never answered her phone.

Catra contacted Mara. Adora and Mara didn't talk that much since Mara left, the schedule of both didn't allow them to have long conversations like when they were younger, so Catra didn't know if lately they've been in contact, but she had to try, so she called Mara several times this month, to know if Adora had called her, to know if she had any idea of how Adora was doing, but Mara said she had only received messages from her niece and it were a few, it was starting to worry her just like everyone.

The worry and stress were becoming too much to bear, it was beginning to consume her, and everyone around Catra could notice it, at first, they were only slightly noticeable signs, she would pay half attention to her classes, check her phone each time she heard a sound but those were slightly becoming more, her hair would be messed up like she was passing her hand through it all the time, under her eyes, purple bags were marking them, now even in the exterior was present the stress she was feeling. In the way she was dressing, talking and even walking, like she didn't know where she was going. Everyone knew this was a hard time for her too.

Cyra convinced Catra to go out of the house sometimes, they had long talks and agreed that going out even if It's just to walk could be great for her, so Glimmer and Bow or Scorpia and Entrapta would invite her all the time to go out with them, having someone to distract her from her own mind was good, but when she was alone in her room at night she wondered how Adora was doing.

Adora never liked being alone, she grew up like that, all the time it was just Catra and Adora, Marlena never liked the fact that Adora had friends, she would tell her that they were a distraction for her, so in the end she would push everyone away but Catra was different, Adora didn't want to let go of her and Catra was stubborn enough to stay at Adora’s side.

Now that they were adults, the blonde let go of those bad habits and appreciated every moment she spent with her friends. Those moments brought her so much joy and happiness, that she wasn't afraid of being attached to people. But now that she was alone, Catra was worried that the isolation would do something to Adora's mental health.

Adora's anxiety would sometimes drive her into a bad place, she would start to think on every possible scenario, even the worst ones, and all those possibilities would make her body start to have an anxiety attack, Catra was most of the time there to help her, making her feel grounded, so now that she was in one space, alone, Catra had every right to feel worried about her best friend.

Today Catra didn't feel like going out, she wanted to try and rest. After school Catra decided to go directly to her mothers' house, she called Glimmer and Bow telling them her plan, her mind was too busy to pay attention to anything.

In the afternoon Catra was with Elena, she had come home from work an hour later after the youngest one of the house had arrived, they were making dinner for when Cyra came from work, sometimes one of the three would make dinner, other times were like now, to them it was a way to make time for each other, they would talk and know how the other was doing.

A sudden noise interrupted their comfortable silence, they realize it was a phone that started to ring, Catra jumped out of her thoughts not noticing that it was her phone the one who was ringing, but when she recognized the ringtone she bolted out of the kitchen knowing who was calling her, she had their favorite song as a special ringtone for that person, they decided it was their song since the first time they heard it. When Catra saw the contact name, she couldn't stop getting a smile on her face, it was an unexpected but pleasant surprise, after the third ring she answered, she didn't want to seem so desperate.

"Hello"

“Hi”, it sounded like a whisper, a sweet voice that brought calm to Catra’s heart, “How are you?”, the voice on the other side continued, it sounded a little shaky, like nervous, Catra wondered why, this isn’t the first time they talked

“Good, thanks for asking, and you?”, Catra tried to sound neutral, but on the inside she was feeling so nervous, talking to her now it felt like when they talked for the first time

"Good… do you think we can meet and… well… talk?”, the voice of the other person was still timid slowly getting confidence

“Yeah”, Catra answered too quickly and breathless, “I mean yes, when do you want to meet”, after saying that she turned to her mom, hope adorned her eyes, the smile in her face was nowhere near to coming off

“What do you think about tomorrow, lunchtime? I could make you something”

“Yeah, I would like that”, the voice on the other side let go of a breath, and said, “Okay, I’ll see you tomorrow”

“See you tomorrow”, Catra hang up and her first reaction after the call was a squeal, she didn't usually do those sounds, but who could really blame her, she was excited, after those it came jumps of happiness in their place

Her mama just looked at her with amusement on her face. Elena turned off the stove and came to where Catra was, she grabbed her shoulder, “What are you so excited about?”

“We’re going to see and talk again tomorrow”

Elena made a grimace, and turned to look away before shaking her head and turned back to her daughter, “Don’t want to ruin the moment, but that can also mean something bad, right?”

Catra stood on her place, her excitement coming down, but still positive, “I know, but she didn’t sound like it could be bad, I don’t

know how to explain it, and honestly I’m just excited to see her again”, she knew he mom was right but her heart was telling her differently, her heart was telling her that everything was going to be fine again

At that moment the front door opened and Cyra came through, she left her keys on the table and looked at her daughter and wife’s faces, curiosity began to show on Cyra’s expression, “Why does one of you look like at any moment it’s going to explode of happiness and the other one look like they just watched a very sad movie?”

“She called and said she wanted to talk tomorrow”, Catra answered, she knew Cyra would agree with her, that she would reassure her

“Who called?, The girl from the coffee shop?”, Cyra said that with curiosity and a little sad expression. Days ago the Diaz family had go to a coffee shop and when Catra was getting their stuff the cashier was flirting with the brunette, but the latter wasn't paying that much of attention, she was more focused on how to get all of their things to the table, of course Cyra noticed the intentions of the other girl but her daughter had a five-six foot tall blonde in her mind to note, when Catra arrived at the table, Cyra and Elena decided not to mention anything, Adora was to attach to their hearts to let her go that easily

“What no, I didn’t even give my number to that girl, I was talking about Adora, she called and asked if we could talk tomorrow”, Catra was confused,but she quickly forgot about that and turned the conversation back to the point

“And why does your mom look so sad and conflicted, it’s good news, isn’t it?”, Cyra was almost as excited and happy as Catra was when she finished her call with Adora

“Yeah, it is but what if she wants to talk, so they can have a clean break up?”, Elena said, a frown on her forehead showing her

feelings, she was worried that her little girl was going to get her heart broken

“Elena, don’t think so negative about this, yes there are a million possibilities for the outcome of this conversation, but the girls love each other so much, you have to trust in that love”, Cyra and Elena had watched their friendship turned into a romantic bond, the girls had confessed their feelings in the backyard of Catra's house, they were stargazing.

Cyra could remember that day like it was yesterday, before Adora had arrived at their house Catra had talked to her mothers to see what she could do so Adora would like her back, what she could say so Adora would be her girlfriend, and in the night under the stars Catra had confess to her best friend that she was in love with her, Adora's cheeks had turned so red, she looked up then at Catra's face to hold her between her hands and kissed her. They were so into each other that they didn't notice the two grown up women looking at them through the window. That night was so special.

“You sounded like a cheese rom-com”, Elena said with a little laugh, “But you’re right, let just hope that their love it’s strong enough”

“Okay, now with everything you just said, I’m starting to get worried”, Catra said, her face now decreased, she was so happy to hear Adora’s voice again, but what if Elena was right? What if Adora wanted to talk to her so they could break up?. Worry and sadness settled in her heart, her stomach dropped and she felt sick

“No, baby, everything's going to be fine, trust me; you and Adora love each other so much, she just needed time and space to herself” Cyra grabbed her hands, guiding her towards the couch.

“Yeah ignore me, you know how worry I get for the people I care, your mom is right, everything it’s going to work out at the end, why don't you stay here in the couch while your mom helps me

finish dinner and finishing we can watch whatever movie you want", Elena was trying to make her feel better, but just like Adora, she had an overthinker mind, so that usually make every situation to her not that positive

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The next day Catra woke up, nerves where running through her, she was going to see her best friend again after three months of no communication.

She doesn't like to admit it but she spent more time than necessary searching for an outfit, she wanted to look good, perfect, for her girlfriend.

Minutes before one in the afternoon, Catra arrived at the house, as she was getting close to the door, the first thing that she noticed were the aspect of the front, close to the windows several plants were a little down giving the looks as if no one took care of them, but not giving too much of importance the brunette knocked on the door and after some seconds later Adora opened the door, at that moment Catra noticed that the plants were not the only ones who needed care. Adora looked pale, skinny, tired, big purple bags under her eyes, her lips looked dry, she displayed the word unhealthy all over her.

But before Catra got a word out about her appearance Adora beat her to it, “Hi” it came out of Adora’s mouth like she was saying something so precious, a breath barely audible, at that moment Catra thought that she would give anything to hear her voice for longer time, she spent three months without hearing Adora’s voice, so hearing it again was like an embrace to her heart.

“Hi”, the brunette answered, her voice just like Adora barely distinguished, both were too nervous to speak again

“Would you like to come in?”

Catra only answered with a nod, the blonde let her come in and went directly to the kitchen, then she turned to Catra, "Do you want to eat or talk first?", Adora's voice was getting more strength

"I think eating first would be fine"

Adora just nodded and grabbed two plates, while she was serving the food, Catra realized that Adora had made her favorite food, at this point the mind of the brunette was making so many scenarios, why had Adora made her favorite food, it was to dump her gently or it was so they could have the opportunity to be together again.

The blonde learned a lot about the typical Colombian food, living with Catra and her family during three years, Elena and Cyra liked to teach the girls different basic things, so most of the time in the weekend the four of them would cook some arepas, empanadas or even bandeja paisa, because even tho they weren't living in Colombia anymore Cyra and Elena wanted the girls to know where they came from, and while Adora wasn't from there she was still part of the family and it was important for her to know the traditions the same for Catra.

The girls get situated at the table and looked at each other just to advertise their looks somewhere else.

The first few minutes were awkward, but it wasn't about comfort, they were always each other safe place, it was more about a silence, so deafening that made the place feel awkward, they wanted to say so much but didn't know if it was the right time or even if the were going to be the right words, there has never been a silence between them, at least no like this one, of course they had their moments when they wanted peace and quiet, but neither of them like the complete silence, in the background it could always be heard music, or Adora's humming, and when they visited, melog's purring was the sound, there was always a sound.

"How have you been", Adora decided she was going to be the first one to talk and Catra didn't mind it

"I've been better and you?", the brunette answered with honesty, they didn't lie to each other, communication and honesty was a big part of their relationship and they respected that

"Same..."

The silence reign again in the room, they were still trying to know what to say that didn't relate to the real issue

"Sorry... it's just... we haven't talk in three months and now we don't know what to say, it weird being in the same room" Adora said looking down at her food, and when she didn't received and answer she looked up at Catra

Catra was freaking out in the inside, her mama was right, Adora was going to break up with her. The blonde had said that it was weird being in the same room as her but before Catra could freak out more, Adora spoke again, maybe noticing the nervous face in Catra

"I... meant a good weird?... No sorry it - sorry I'm nervous, what I'm trying to say it's... I'm glad to see you again", several feelings were going through both of them as Adora spoke.

Catra was in a state of shock until her body let itself relax, Adora was glad to see her, maybe this wasn't a break up after all, and she unexpectedly started to laugh, Adora looked at the brunette with amusement in her face, guess neither of the was expecting Catra to laugh

"It crazy isn't it, we know each other a long time, almost all our whole lives and we are nervous to speak to each other... and by the way I'm glad to see you again too"

After that their conversation flowed, it was like time between them didn't happened, they were back at being Catra and Adora against the whole world, but that happiness was interrupted when

they finished eating, they knew they had to talk about their fight but neither of them were ready to let go of the joy.

They left the dishes on the sink and went to sit on the couch, it was a similar position as last time, Adora in one end and Catra on the other

“So have you talked to any of our friends?”, Catra decided that now it was her turn to talk first, but she was dreading the time, she really just wanted to go back to the way they used to be

“No… I was- I wanted- I missed you… so much. I wanted to hear your voice first, I wanted to see you again first”

“Oh… everyone it worried about you”

Surprise colored Adora’s face, Oh how Catra missed her face, “I really wanted to talk to everyone else, but my mind didn’t leave my alone so you know, I needed-”

“Space, I know”, Catra smiled and put her hand above Adora's one, the blonde turned to see her and gave her a small smile

"I hope you really know I'm sorry, I thought of all the things I said to you that night and… I was scared I didn't want you to be hurt by them again… I'm sorry", tears where forming in Catra's eyes, she really regret the words she said, but not her intentions, she was only trying to protect Adora

"I understand why you did it even though that wasn't the way to do it... And I know you are sorry, you have never hurt me, at least not intentionally… besides I really miss you and I don't want to spend another day without you, yes we are going to have to work on our relationship because trust was really broken that day, and we would have to build what we had, but I am sure that as long as I have you by my side everything it's going to be okay", Adora said surprising Catra, the brunette really didn't expect this outcome but she was happy to have her lover again by her side

"Does that mean I can come back to the house or do you still need space?"

"You can come back… only if you want of course", nervousness had returned to Adora's mind

"Yeah... Of course, I want to be back home, I really missed you and I will work hard to get your trust back"

"Promise?"

"Promise"

Chapter End Notes

So... what do you think of the chapther??.
In all honestly school has been hard lately, I think I don't want to keep studying the carrer I'm in, so homework had been hard, an take more time of me than what I thought it would, so really thank you fro your patience.

You know Kudos and comments always bright my day, and if some data of the story are wrong don't doubt letting me know, I'm not Colombian, I'm actually Mexican so I don't know much about Colombia, but on past chapter someone suggested that I made Catra Colombian so here it is

Have a great day, night and week :)

Ruined with brawling

Chapter Summary

Some time together isn't bad, and the best friend squad it's back, so now will everything be alright?

Chapter Notes

Hi, I'm back with a new chapter, this one it isn't that long but I'm working on the next one and it's going amazing, I hope you like this one, and thanks for still being around.
Happy reading!!

I made a Spotify playlist for this story, if you want to check out here is the link (hope it works), and if you have suggestions for more songs you can put them in the comments!

Link: Spotify Playlist

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Beauty soon grows familiar to the lover,
Fades in his eye, and palls upon the sense.
Joseph Addison, Cato, A Tragedy (1713), Act I, scene 4

They talked like tomorrow didn’t exist, trying to make each minute that passed more memorable, exhaustion was catching up to them, but moving from the couch wasn’t even an option at this point, so a nap will do, for now, the only issue was that, they were still a little nervous around each other, still insecure of how to interact with each other, they knew that it shouldn't be like this, but time passes, and usually it changes things, they were just glad to be at each other's arms again. Catra hoped that it

wouldn’t take a lot of time for them to get back their relationship, but it felt wrong to have that wish.

After some hesitation, Adora stayed at Catra's side, not because she didn’t want to, it was more about if Catra wanted or if they were ready to be like this again so soon, but if they wanted this to work, they had to trust each other. The blonde turned on the TV, she let a movie play in the background so they could have noise while they slept. It was their dynamic, like old times, of course, it was different in their interactions but with some patience and work it could be like it used to be.

Catra knew trust was an important thing to Adora, the blonde didn't really trust easily, fearing that in the end, those people she put her trust in would end up breaking her soul apart just like her mother had done, and Catra had feared that she had done exactly that, but if that was the case Adora wouldn't have called her and this moment would be completely different.

Now Catra had to gain the trust Adora lost for her, of course, it wasn't all but it was a part, they had to work on each other, they had to gain back what they lost, Catra just hoped it wasn't much.

Adora began to talk to Catra about TV shows she watched, the difficulty she had in some school works, and even things she bought, and Catra talked back about a lot of stuff, she mentioned school, going in outs with friends, dinners with her mothers.

They were simply enjoying each other's company, and for now, that was enough.

Moments passed between them that made them fall in love all over again with each other, Adora would sometimes lay awake until Catra would fall asleep, observing her, admiring how her girlfriend’s skin felt so soft under her fingertips, how light puffs of air that were coming out of her lips, and the several freckles that were scattered all over her nose and cheeks, adorning, even more, her face, appreciating every moment together.

From the brunette side, it wasn’t very different, Catra would stay still on the couch seeing how Adora would prepare breakfast in the kitchen, the muscles on her back flexing each time she would take something, her head and hips moving side to side from the music on the speaker and even the tip of her tongue out in concentration, sometimes her blonde hair would be cascading until it reached mid-back.

After everything they have been through, they decided to take each moment together and keep it in a box in their hearts, they wanted to protect their dreams, hugs, kisses, words of reasurement, so only they could see back at their time together, they wanted to keep those moments they lost those months apart and now were coming back at their lives, to themselves.

As days passed Adora started to feel better, and with Catra's company and help the blonde began to message and call their friends, she just wanted to know how they were doing, and catch up on what she missed, she also started to call Mara more often, Adora missed the company, she had missed the closeness with people she appreciated, and this was just the begging to go back as everything was.

When Catra told the news to her mothers it was like they announced monumental news, Elena and Cyra were more than thrilled to hear that the girls were back together. On the weekend they decided to take the girls out to dinner, the four of them enjoying going out again, like old times, their family was back together.

And just like Elena and Cyra, when the news arrived at the other duo of the group, it was a matter of time so they could be reunited again, Adora wasn't the only one who missed the time when everyone was reunited.

Glimmer and Bow came to visit them regularly, the talks and meals at their table at school, the sleepovers at their house, the going outs, all of it was coming back, and even if everything looked better, Catra had a feeling that something was going to

happen, she didn't really know if she was being paranoid or if something was really going to happen, last time she ignored it, Adora's parents came back and everything went downhill, but now, there wasn't any clue as to what maybe will occur.

But this time would be different because now she will make sure everything will be alright, better.

On the other side of the room, far from Catra's thoughts, Adora was having a storm in her mind, her heart feeling heavy, she was grateful when she was with her friends, they helped a lot of keeping her far from the awful side of her mind, they helped calm down the racing thoughts.

When Adora spent time alone, her anxiety would come for her and keep on dragging her down, Marlena was still tormenting her, the words and actions her mother had shown that day had affected her deeply, even if she hasn't seen her in three months, her mother's words were constantly screaming in her brain, bringing her mood and self-love down, Adora knows what it's happening inside her body and mind but still doesn't prevent it from happening because she believes she deserves it.

A month later

The best friend squad was watching a movie, at the girl's house, Glimmer and Bow were sitting together at the couch, a bowl half-full of popcorn between them, Glimmer's head was resting at Bow's shoulder, sleep was coming for her, at their right were Catra and Adora, the brunette's head was on her girlfriend's lap, it was almost two in the morning, they had spent the whole day together, it was Saturday so nobody had anything to do, and since the past incident, they wanted to spend most of their free time together.

Adora looked so focused on the movie but in reality, her mind kept on bugging her, her thoughts were always intruding on the moments she wanted to enjoy, but everyone was so oblivious

about her struggles, she was so on her mind that she didn’t notice the look her girlfriend was giving her.

Catra was thinking that, even after all these years together Adora hadn't lost her beauty, she was a gorgeous human being inside out, physically, Adora was tall, blonde and those radiant gray-blue eyes that provoke warmth to anyone who saw them, she was the type of person who could captivate anyone near her, and on the inside, Catra could swear her heart was made of gold, Adora was sweet, selfless, a good listener and if she didn't know any better Catra could confidently say that her girlfriend was a Goddess walking among the earth.

But Catra did know, Adora was this sweet human that needed to be protected because if someone didn't do it for her no one could have ever noticed how broken Adora was, she always tried to hide it, with a simple smile and cheerful expressions she could tell everyone she was fine just so she wouldn't be a burden to someone else, Catra saw the true and real Adora, the one who hid under those massive walls around her, and that was because they had grown up together.

And Catra would never regret being Adora's protector.

Two weeks later

On the weekends, sometimes, the girls would make sleepovers with their other two best friends. The four of them, after school, would go to Adora and Catra's house, prepare snacks and big dinners, review at least two times the catalog of movies, prepare the living room with big blankets, the four would prepare everything to have the best sleepover, that most of the time, used to long all weekend.

But as everyone spent the night together, the group minus Adora started to notice a thing about the latter, she would eat less, or sometimes not eat at all. The blonde would make excuses saying she wasn't that hungry or that she had already grabbed snacks.

Adora loved the food, before the incident she was always hungry and could eat a lot in one sitting, and maybe it was for the exercise she did, but after the fight and the distance, she went less and less to the gym, so the lack of hunger was now blamed on the fact that she was doing less exercise. Her friends weren't worried, they just thought it was a weird situation.

Catra knew what meant the lack of hunger, but she really didn't want to believe that it could happen again, Adora had promised her it wouldn't happen again, and Catra blindly believed her.

Chapter End Notes

So, what do you think of this chapter, I wanted to give them time to relax a little bit, because the next one it's a strong one, and maybe even one of my favorites I've ever written.

I know I haven't updated so constant but I'm almost finishing my semester so it's going one of two ways, one I'll update more frequently or the next three chapters will be updated after I finish with school, but I hope it's the first option.

As you all know you can message me or comment if you see a mistake or if you liked it, or what do you think about this situation, remember I'm mostly writing this by experience so maybe some thing won't be realistic to you

I appreciate every kudos and comment you give me. You can also follow me on twitter as @reader_sof, there I will update if another story comes to my mind, I already have like three but they don't have published date

Have a great day, nigh, week! :)

And caterwauling

Chapter Summary

More angst on our way. Is Adora fine now that everyone she loves is back in her life?

TW: mentions of eating disorders and medical explanations

Chapter Notes

Hi!!!. I'm back with a new chapter, this one it's a little stronger but not too much, remember that if some data are not how you know them doesn't mean they're wrong, I'm basing mostly on personal experience.

I hope you like this chapter, and please read the notes at the end.

TW: mentions of eating disorders and medical explanations

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Break the bones and the body will heal.
Break the spirit and the body will die.
Anonymous proverb, in Dictionary of Proverbs (2005) by G. Kleiser, p. 31

Catra and Adora were spending the rest of the day watching the TV, they wanted to rest from everything, the school was being, each day more difficult, so they decided that today was going to be used so they could relax.

They were sitting on the couch, Adora had her feet up on the coffee table in front of them and Catra was curled up on Adora's left side, the blonde had her arm around Catra's shoulder, going up and down in the length of her arm. They were in complete silence watching a series until Adora interrupted it, she looked

down at Catra and made sure that her girlfriend was looking at her face before speaking

“You know I love you, right?”, Adora asked, in her eyes was a different type of spark, Catra couldn’t identify what it was or meant

“Yeah, and I love you too”, “Why do you ask that? Is everything alright?”

Yes, I was just making sure you knew it”

And with that, the talk finished, Catra didn't know what to make out of it, but she wasn't going to think too hard about it. She just wanted to enjoy this day

A week later

Glimmer was on her way toward Catra and Adora's house, she had made plans to make dinner with Adora, so the best friend squad could have a night together, the blonde had finished classes early and knew that Glimmer was also going to finish at an early hour, they talk and agreed to make dinner instead of calling for delivery, and one of the best sides of this situation was that they were finally going to spend time together just the two of them.

Things were a little rough lately, everyone had a lot of school work making them so busy almost every day, but they still tried to make time for each other, even if were some minutes.

One day Catra knew that the teachers were starting to order less homework, so she decided it was a good idea for them to reunite, even if it’s just one night; but the one who always makes excuses for not assisting was Adora, and now, to no one’s surprise she dejected again the invite, Catra tried to talk to her, she didn’t know why Adora was pushing everyone again, even if the blonde didn’t notice or wasn’t making it on purpose.

So now after some weeks, Adora said she was available that day, and the resting trio wasn’t going to let that opportunity go, so

they make plans and now Glimmer was on her way to her best friend’s house, she was excited, the four of them again after some hard weeks of school was a good idea.

Glimmer was happy but sadness was creeping on her, after what happened she thought that the four of them were going to be joined by the hip, but that was a naive dream, at first they were together, but then other things started to appear on their way somehow putting distance between them, they were several factors, that the separation couldn’t be blamed on something. There was the school, the teachers were making them do piles of works, overtired them all the time, there was also the factor of sleep, sometimes they were so tired that they didn’t have any energy available to make anything, and the final and more sad reason was that Adora sometimes didn’t want to spend time with them, she would say it was because she was tired or had a lot to do but the blonde was a crappy liar so everyone could see that she was just avoiding spending time with them, but none of the three could think of a reason to why she was doing it.

Glimmer got out of her car and knocked on the principal door, when she didn't get an answer, she knocked again and again. Glimmer called Adora on her phone but she didn't receive an answer from there either, Glimmer was starting to get nervous, Adora always answered her phone and her car was on the driveway so she supposed that the blonde was home. She remembered that the girls always left a key close to the window in case one of them forgot their key. Entering the house Glimmer noticed the deafening silence, the house was never that way, she knew that her friend didn’t like when their house was without a sound, going deeper into the house, she started to call Adora's name, still never receiving an answer.

Glimmer didn’t know if she should call Bow, Catra or wait on the couch, maybe Adora went on a walk outside the house to try and clear her mind, they were so many possibilities and so fewer answers, so Glimmer decided to go upstairs and call Adora’s name, maybe her friend was just asleep.

She went to Adora's room and knocked on the door, the nervousness on her body was getting worse, she advertised that she will be entering the room in case Adora didn't hear her entering the house before. She opened the door but didn't notice anything out of the ordinary, the curtains were closed, the bed was made and on the floor, there wasn’t anything out of place, it was like no one had ever put a foot in there.

She was on her way out to the hall when she noticed that the light of the bathroom was on, the door of this space was slightly open and no sound was coming out of there, as she was getting closer, Glimmer started to take out her phone, she called Adora's number, a ringtone sounded breaking the silence, making know that the noise was coming from the bathroom or some place close, Glimmer approached slowly and finished opening the ajar door, but a soon as her movements started it became to a halt when she noticed the unconscious body on the floor

The chest of the body was going up and down awfully slow, close to the blonde hair, that it was out of the usual ponytail, was a line of blood and it reached the cheek, Glimmer dropped on her knees and try to see if her best friend was still breathing, she heard the ragged breath that was coming out of the mouth, it was barely there, grabbing her shoulders, Glimmer started to shake her, shock and fear was dominating her body and mind, she didn’t know what to do, this wasn’t usual and it wasn’t something they teach you at school. She left Adora’s body again on the floor, and tried to calm her own breathing, when she got somehow a little bit more calm, she called the ambulance.

Catra was in the library of the university, her notebook and a textbook in front of her, she was supposed to be in class but it was canceled at the last minute, she wanted to go home but she knew that Glimmer wanted to spend time with her absent best friend and Catra wasn’t going to interrupt their time, so she decided to stay at the library and do some homework.

She was trying so hard to focus on the work in front of her but her mind had other plans, she was thinking about Adora, but not in the romantic kind of way, it was more that she was worried about Adora and also about their relationship, they had fixed their problem some months ago, of course, they were sometimes moments of tension that reminded both of them their time apart but mostly they were like before, happy with each other.

One of the many concerns that were nagging her right now was school, it was getting more difficult lately, piles of works were drowning her causing that most of the time her lunches with Adora were postponed or even canceled, she felt bad, but in the night she recompenses with making dinner, so they at least could have a meal together, making time for each other.

Besides that, they barely got time to talk, but not because they didn't want to interact with each other, the cause was their schedules, those were the major problem, and to add to all of that, Catra started to notice changes in Adora. Changes that she has noticed before, attitudes that were present in her girlfriend's life in previous years, and those little shifts in the behavior were just barely noticeable to people who have been through that or have someone who has lived through it.

Those changes were like sometimes skipping a meal saying she isn't hungry or that she'll eat later, the blonde also started to spend more time at the gym saying that she had to get back the months she didn't do exercise, and weirdly, Adora would say that all the time she is tired. Catra doesn't know what's going on, or she likes to think that, because if it has been what the back of her mind is telling her that it is, Adora it's in more problems. Catra is concerned for Adora, but she hasn't had the time to talk about it to Adora because, again, a lot of her time it's being occupied with more things.

Catra decided it was enough time in the library, she wanted to see her girlfriend, so she started to pick up her stuff; she finished and went to exit the library, walking towards her car, she got out her

phone and was about to send a text to Adora informing her that she was on her way to the house when Glimmer's call entered.

She didn't know why, but a pressure in her chest started to appear, usually, the four members of the best friend squad communicate via texts, unless it is an emergency that's when they call, then know that sometimes they are in classes or doing important stuff so they make sure to not interrupt each other, so now Glimmer was calling her, fear was whispering in her brain different scenarios, she is not paranoid but Adora was supposed to be with her, so if Glimmer it's calling maybe it has something to do with the blonde.

Catra pressed the button to accept the call, pulled her phone toward her ear, and answered, *"Hello"*, her tone was uninterested and didn't reveal any of her true emotions, the storm that was forming in her heart and mind.

"*Catra, something happened, it's about Adora*", Glimmer said, urgency in her voice, combined with fear, Catra heart just dropped

"*What happened? Is she okay? Where are you?*", Catra said, her steps more quickly so she could arrive at her car, her breathing becoming more ragged each minute it passes

"*We are at the hospital, I don't really know what happened, but I'll explain what I know when you arrive*"

"*... I'm on my way*", and with that Catra hung up, her mind going in a thousand directions, the pressure in her chest was still there, her heart felt like it could go out at any minute, her stomach felt like it was in a twist, she didn't feel like driving but her girlfriend needed her, so got in her car and as she got closer to the hospital, every feeling was getting worse.

The moment Catra arrived at the hospital, her eyes traveled on the whole floor looking for her friends. When she found Glimmer and Bow, she noticed that they were on the couch, Bow had an arm around Glimmer's shoulders.

Glimmer raised her head from Bow's shoulder, and looked directly at Catra, her eyes had fear and worry swimming on them, she got up as Catra was making her way toward them.

"What happened, it's Adora alright?", was the first thing to come out of Catra's mouth, she was desperate to know what was going on. The last time Adora was in a hospital, it wasn't good news, and now she feared it was the same reason she was here now.

"The doctors are still doing exams on her, they want to be sure what happened before they come to inform us", Catra noticed that Bow's voice was like a whisper, it could be barely heard.

Before Catra could open her mouth again, Glimmer intervened this time, looking at the floor she started to tell both of them what had happened, "I arrived at your house and knocked on the door but I didn't hear anything, so I called her and she didn't answer, so I supposed she was asleep, I entered the house with the spare key and kept on calling her, but I didn't hear anything, I went upstairs… the house was so silent"

Glimmer was about to cry, Catra noticed, her friend's eyes were becoming red like she was holding back tears "I was about to go back downstairs when I noticed that the door to the bathroom was slightly open, I called Adora's name and phone one last time, it sounded there, in the bathroom so I opened the door and there she was… on the floor… unconscious… blood was coming from her forehead"

As she was finishing the phrase, she looked up at Catra, to them continuing telling, "I was so scared, I didn't know what to do so I called the ambulance and then you two, without moving, she looked so pale and even more thin than before", Glimmer's breath was coming labored, her hand slightly shaking, with his other arm, Bow grabbed his girlfriend's hands

After hearing all of this, Catra felt so sick, in her mind, questions were coming quickly, and were blaming her for what had happened. The corners of her brain were asking why she didn't

notice it before? she knew what Adora has been through, she has seen these signs before, if she knew then why she didn't do anything? she could have stopped this from happening, her guilty was slowly consuming her, she regretted not doing anything about it.

Before she could go too deep into that dark hole, a doctor came to them asking if they were family of Adora, Catra got up from the chair and said that she was her wife, she had been through this before she knew that if they weren't family, the doctors weren't going to tell them anything, and she needed to know so she asked if Adora was alright, "Ms. Gray it's not in critical condition, she fainted, the fall made that her head collided with, most likely the floor, causing the injury on the head and a contusion, she would be fine, right now she is sleeping, don't worry too much if she doesn't wake up the rest of the night, her body needs the rest"

"Thank you so much. Can we go to her room and see her?", Bow talked, noticing that Catra and Glimmer were still processing everything

"Not yet, there it's something I still want to talk about with you", the doctor's face doesn't reveal anything but seriousness, Catra has maybe an idea as to what the doctor wants to talk about, but her mind doesn't want to go there, she wants to believe that other stuff caused Adora to faint

"What is it about?", this time is Glimmer the one who talks

-"We did some tests, and we may have a reason to think that she has an eating disorder, of course, we still need to do some questions to Ms. Gray but on the results, we saw that her hydration levels were low and the vitamins necessaries as well, the temperature of her body was low, those are just some indicators that most of the people with an eating disorder suffers from, so we're waiting for her to wake up and make some questions to see how can we treat her..."

As the doctor kept on talking, Catra just looked down trying to not show that she was crying she turned everyone around her out, she didn't want to listen any more of this. Catra was thinking about how this could have happened, Adora was free of that for several years, she was recovering, she was fine until her parents visited her, they had to bring her down again as always.

Glimmer and Bow nodded at the doctor and turned to Catra, but she was still deep in her thoughts, Glimmer touched Catra's shoulder to call for her attention, and Catra just jumped as she was focusing on them, also noticing that the doctor had left.

"Did the doctor tell you where Adora's room is?", said Catra trying to keep her voice and face blank, so they couldn't know what a mess it was inside Catra's mind, she just wanted to look at how Adora was doing

"Catra, are you okay?", Bow said after sharing a look with Glimmer, his face showing fear and some confusion

"Why do you ask that?", as she finished she turned, so she could walk on the way toward the patients' room

"Because you didn't react the way we thought you'll react", this time it was Glimmer the one who talked

"And how did you think I'll react", as she was talking, Catra went looking for Adora's room, her heart was pounding really strong like at any time it could go out, her mind thinking why she didn't do anything to prevent this from happening, again; her stomach feels like it was tied in a knot, all of her felt sick. All these feelings were once again in her life, the last time she felt all of this was years ago and was because of the same situation Adora is now at the hospital.

"I don't know maybe more attentive to what the doctor was saying or demanding to see Adora, or anything else but blank like you didn't care for her", in Glimmer's voice was a tint of fury and

Catra couldn’t understand why, nor she wanted to understand, her focus was solemnly on Adora right now

At this Catra stopped completely, she turned to her friends slowly, the hurt that her face was showing, was quickly turning into anger, “You think I don’t care for her, we’ve been in each other life since we were toddlers. I’ve been in her best and worst moments and because of that I know that this isn’t the first time that this has happened, I know how to deal with this, sorry for not showing my emotions and trying to conceal my emotions so I can help Adora to be better”.

Glimmer and Bow gave a step back, both trying to process all the things Catra just said. They stood there in the middle of the hall, almost complete silence around them, the thing that still could be heard was the talk between Doctors and nurses, but closer Catra’s elaborated breath was louder, seeing that her friend wasn’t moving, she turned and took back her path to Adora’s room.

When Catra enters the room, she hears the heart monitor, her own heart now pulsing normally, the first thing she saw was a window, it was giving the cold and white room a little light, then she turned her head to the right and noticed the bed, in there was Adora, her eyes closed and her chest going up and down with each breath she was taking.

Catra went to sit beside Adora, taking the left hand of her lover on her own, watching Adora’s face with intensity, as if with her look she could make Adora wake up. Some time later she hears the door of the room is being open and two pairs of steps coming closer to the bed, they come closer to them but decide to be on the right side of Adora, Glimmer it’s the one to take the seat, Bow behind her grabbing her shoulders.

Catra would give anything to see that smile again, Adora had a smile that could light any room, even If she didn't notice, while growing up, Adora had trouble accepting she was enough by just being herself, she had trouble seeing that no matter what she was gorgeous, she was a goddess walking on earth and she didn't

notice. Marlena was the cause, she would degrade Adora for no reason, and all that Adora wanted was for her mother to accept her.

When she was a teen, Marlena would say to Adora that she was gaining weight so she should stop eating, or that she wouldn’t be loved if they knew how much she ate, those and more comments caused Adora to actually stop eating or eat but in little portion, sometimes she would go to the option of vomiting her food. Catra didn't notice until years later, Adora has hidden it very good, and Catra started to suspect because Adora fainted at school, the nurse had said it was because she hadn't had breakfast, so Catra had made Adora eat her lunch, but in her face, the brunette saw the doubt, the fear, and disgust for the food.

Catra confirmed when Adora was living in her house, Cyra and Elena had gotten out for groceries and Adora had gone to take a shower, Catra was downstairs watching some TV when she heard a thud on the ceiling, she went running upstairs calling for Adora but she never heard an answer, and that's when she risked entering the bathroom, she didn't want to break her best friend privacy but she was worried. Catra entered and saw Adora on the floor, a towel covering her body, the brunette kept on calling the blonde who was unconscious, Catra quickly called her mothers as she was dragging Adora's body toward her room to dress her and take her to the hospital.

Adora looked bad, under her eyes were purple bags, evidence that she wasn't sleeping well, her cheeks were thinner same as her arms and legs, and that it when Catra noticed, something was wrong with Adora and she hadn't found out sooner.

Now, they were at the hospital for the same reason, and like last time, all that they could do was wait.

Chapter End Notes

So, what do you'll think of this chapter?. If my explanations aren't that precise I'm sorry I'm not an expert but I try my

best with my knowledge.

I published this before because I'm almost finishing school so I don't know if I will have time to publish it, probably this next two or three are going to be very busy for me but I'll try to publish the next ones.

All kudos and comments are always appreciated, so thank you!!

Have a good day, night and week! :)

Enchant no more

Chapter Summary

Adora's still at the hospital and that brings memories to Catra, some are good and the others not so much

Chapter Notes

Hi!!! I'm back with a new chapter and well, this it's the longest chapter I've ever written and I'm so excited for you to read it. I don't know if you've noticed but the chapter count got up by one, the last chapter will be an epilogue, but it isn't ready yet, so I would work on it

TW: Eating disorders and Psychological abuse are mentioned so read at your own precautions

Again if you think some things aren't accurate just remember that everyone has different experience with these things, I mostly expressing my experience

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Your absence of mind we have borne, till your presence of body came to be called in question by it.
Charles Lamb, "Amicus Redivivus", Last Essays of Elia (1833)

Catra was by Adora's side, her hand was holding her girlfriend's cold one, Adora's skin was pale, green and purple lines visible all the way in her arm, her chest was barely going up and down if it weren't for the machine on her other side, Catra would have thought Adora wasn't breathing, somehow, it could be seen her cheekbones and her jaw was even now more pronounced than before, everything in her body screamed sick and everyone had ignored it.

It wasn’t the first time Adora was at the hospital, but Catra really thought, that the last time was going to be the only time Adora would be there, after the first time they had a really long talk, as to what they could do to avoid all this, Cyra and Elena were there to help too, the four of them were working on it, with that support system Adora would never feel like that again or that it’s what they thought.

Catra called her mothers’ to notify them about the situation, they needed to know, they had visited them last week and left with hugs and smiles, now Catra would be giving them awful news, her mothers really cared about the blonde, just like with Catra, they had a special bond, one that it was formed during almost 17 years and even if Marlena and Randor weren’t happy about it, Adora appreciated the Diaz family like it was her own, and they didn’t dare to take that away from her.

As expected her mothers didn’t take well the news, Elena told her that she was picking up Cyra from work and immediately they would go to the hospital, they wanted to be there for Catra and Adora.

She was waiting for her mothers when memories started to appear in her mind, it would go from childhood to days ago, those were special moments, moments when her friendship or love and even sadness would be strong even if those moments weren’t special or even relevant to other people, to her and to her heart those memories were irreplaceable because those were parts of her life that made her learn.

Seventeen years ago

Her mothers and she had just moved to another house, she really doesn’t know why but it’s good, her mom Cyra told her there was a park nearby, maybe she will get friends. In a few weeks, she was going to start preschool, she didn’t know what she was going to do there but maybe she could play, she likes to play.

Her new room was bigger than the one she had before, and she also had a bigger bed, she was going to fill it with a lot of stuffed animals.

As she was going down the stairs, she heard her mothers calling her when she arrived in front of them, they told her they were going to the park so she furiously nodded to go, she wanted to explore the new places around her

The park was so big, it had a lot of trees, some of them had their leaves orange and others didn't have any leaves at all, there were also a lot of places where she could play, her moms let her go with the condition she stayed close, so they could see her, and she just nodded before leaving.

Catra was sitting in front of her moms, on the grass playing with some dolls that she brought from the house, she was getting bored, it's never fun when someone it's playing alone, she was going to tell her mommy Elena if she could play with her when a shadow appeared above her.

When she looked up to see what was blocking the light, she noticed her, it was a girl, probably her age, a ponytail was holding back her light blonde hair; she was smiling at Catra. The girl sat down in front of her, "Hi, I'm Adora", came out of her mouth, her voice sounded sweet and calming like she was trying to be friends with Catra

"I'm Catra"

"Are you new?", as she was asking her question, her blonde head was going down on a side, like dogs when they are curious about something, Catra knew that because she had asked her mother why grandma's dog did that.

"How do you know that?", Catra was a little scared, had Adora seen her in her house, did the house have cameras, what was happening

"Well, I always come to the park with my daddy, and I have never seen you here"

"Oh… yeah I'm new, I moved to another house with my mommies"

"So do you have any friends?"

"No…"

"Would you like to be friends with me? I don't have friends either"

"Yes, I would like to be your friend"

After that conversation Catra and Adora started to play together until it was time to go, Randor met Cyra and Elena and with the girls made plans so the girls could keep playing together, the girls said their goodbyes, and they told each other that they would see the next day.

That was the start of their friendship.

That was their start.

Fourteen years ago

Adora had just turned six years, she never had parties so as usual, she didn't have any party this year, her mother didn't like that stuff, her dad had tried to convince her mother but she had refused, so angry at the situation or at her husband she didn't see another remedy than scream at Adora.

Marlena had told her why she had to ask for a lot, why couldn't she be a nice girl and don't ask for anything, told her that every time she asked for something that she wanted she was being annoying, so from there on, Adora never asked for anything.

But the Diaz family had other plans, they went to her house later on her birthday and with Randor's permission they took Adora to eat at a restaurant, then they took Adora to watch movies and do

other activities, they wanted Adora to have one of the best birthdays, and it was all planned by Catra.

What Catra remembers the most about that day was Adora's face as they were dropping her at her house, she had tears in her gray-blue eyes, before getting out of the car, Adora hugged Catra, her tiny arms were strongly wrapped on Catra's shoulders, they let go of each other, and before closing the car's door she said, in a breathless and tiny voice "Thank you".

Catra saw when she closed the door to her house, then she left on her way to her own home with her moms. When she was on her bed remembering all that happened that day a smile came to her face, she had fun and it looked like Adora did too, Adora was a laughing mess all day, her eyes and smile were brighter than any other day and Catra was happy to know that she was the reason for Adora to be smiling.

Ten years ago

Adora and Catra were almost always in the same classes, from kindergarten to now that they were in fifth grade, most of the time after classes they would go to one of the girls' houses to do homework together. Right now they were at Catra's home, Elena was working so Cyra was the one who was taking care of the girls, Adora didn't want to leave, her mother was each day more angry at her and she didn't know why, and Catra could see the mood Adora had every time they talk about her parents so the brunette convinced her mom to speak to Randor and let Adora stay for the night.

Cyra agreed and went to call Adora's dad, the girls went up to Catra's room to play, and when they heard the footsteps on the stairs they were nervous because if Marlena answered the phone Adora was going to be picked up in two hours but if Randor answered then they could have their sleepover.

They heard the door being open, and Catra didn't hesitate to take Adora's hand, the blonde as a normal response, squeezed Catra's

hand, Cyra entered the room, she looked at the girls' hands then at their faces, she had a smile on her own, and that confirmed that their night could be spent together.

Catra jumped and hugged Adora, the girls were so happy to spend even more time together that they started to organize what they would be doing all night, nobody was going to tell them that they should sleep early it was Friday after all so the next day they didn't have any school.

Cyra let them, she had said something but neither of the girls had paid attention, they were too focused on each other that they didn't notice anything or anyone else that night they spend together.

Seven years ago

The girls were starting school, this time they were in eighth grade, as usual, most of their classes were together and some other they would be separated, and then at lunch, they would find an available table to spend that time together, they were used to that routine.

Catra was waiting for Adora at a table, her lunch was sprayed out in front of her, some of her classes were pretty boring, those classes were the ones she didn't share with her best friend, and now that she was alone she was getting bored again, Adora should have arrived by now, so where was she?

As minutes passed, Catra was starting to worry it wasn't like Adora to not appear, and she knew that she had assisted at school, they were together on their first three classes, and now that she was thinking about it, Adora seemed weird and sad but when Catra asked about it Adora just shook her head and they were interrupted by the teacher so Catra couldn't continue the conversation.

Remembering now, Catra put her lunch back in her backpack and went looking for Adora, after some time she still couldn't find her

and was getting more worried each minute that it passed, she didn't know where else she could look for her best friend, she had already checked the art classroom, the music classroom, and even the science classroom but she wasn't in any of them.

The one place she could think right now where maybe she could be was the library, so she went there not even caring if classes were starting again in some minutes.

When she entered, the first thing she noticed was how lonely this place was, maybe because everyone was either eating in the cafeteria or in classes, so she went to look for Adora.

She went directly to the section of astronomy, Adora loves the universe, more specifically the stars, they have spent nights on Catra's patio just to look at the sky.

Adora could name every constellation while her own stars were shining in her eyes and Catra could spend all night listening to her.

A girl was sitting on the floor when Catra arrived at the section, it was Adora, she could recognize that ponytail anywhere, the blonde was reading something but her eyes and mind weren't really there, it was like she was watching the page but nothing was sticking, Catra sited beside her trying to not disturbed her.

Catra turned her face to her left so she could see Adora better, her gray-blue eyes were holding back tears

"Wanna talk about it", Catra whispered, she wanted to know how could she help her best friend

"It's my mother", her voice sounded so scared and sad, her eyes were still on the book

"Why did she say this time?"

"Just some things, but I don't think I'm ready to talk about them"

"Okay, I'll be here all the time you need me"

"You promise?"

"I promise"

Five years ago

Twelve years, they had known each other for at least twelve years, and in all those years they had been through a lot, but what happens today or doesn't happen would change everything in their relationship, Catra has known for a while and had talked to her moms about it, she thinks she is ready but what if Adora doesn't feel the same way.

Cyra had told her that if she was sure about her feelings it was better to let them out, she needed to talk to Adora because communication it's important and because she can't assume what other people's thoughts or feelings are.

So after some sleepless nights and several investigations later, Catra prepared something for Adora, the blonde was staying at the Diaz house for the weekend, she thought it would be cool of having dinner in the backyard and put a camo there, of course, her moms helped her, the only thing she requires to complete everything it's Adora.

Adora arrived close to seven of the night, her mother had told her that she could go if she finished her homework first, so she did it, then her father drop her at Catra's house, today, the brunette noticed that she wasn't so happy as in the morning, she supposed it was Marlena the one who influence in her mood; now it was up to her to make her best friend happy, not that she was complaining.

After telling the blonde what they were going to do, she was more bright, stargazing was one of her favorite activities.

After they had dinner and some talk they decided to put a blanket nest to the table where they had eaten, it was a zone where they could appreciate the sky, and even if the pollution didn't let them

see very well, Adora could name the constellations by heart, she liked it because each one had a story.

Catra turned to Adora, the blonde was watching the shining stars, in her face a smile was, she looked like she could live in that moment forever. Catra was about to talk but Adora had turned to her, making her stop, her brain couldn't process any words, her mind was just thinking how beautiful Adora was, her blonde hair was out of the ponytail, instead it was cascading her round face, her gray-blue eyes were still holding that spark even thou she wasn't looking at the stars anymore, her smile was so bright it rivaled the light of the stars; Adora looked happy, looked at peace, she looked with an emotion that Catra couldn't decipher, which was weird, she could read Adora like an open book.

They were staring at each other's eyes, totally lost in the other, until Adora spoke, she said the word that Catra wasn't expecting coming out of her mouth, she said the words that were in Catra's throat, she said:

"I'm in love with you", her voice had come in a whisper, like if she spoke louder their moment would be ruined, she said it with a breathless tone

"I've been in love with you since I know what it's love, my heart belongs to you and it has always been yours"

Catra was about to cry, she was nervous all along and Adora did reciprocate her feelings, they were in love with their best friend

"I'm in love with you too"

They smiled, even more, their cheeks started to hurt from how hard they were smiling. They were getting closer than before, they stopped until their faces were a few inches apart. Adora looked at Catra's lips while Catra did the same with Adora, they turned their look again at each other's eyes, and that it's when it happened.

Their first kiss

Of course, it was sloppy and a little uncomfortable because of their positions but they find it that they didn't care, Catra felt like the most lucky person in the world, she had finally kissed Adora.

Three years ago

Adora has been living in Catra's house for at least four months, Catra could notice that the blonde had her up and down's moments, sometimes she would find interesting her work for the school, and other times she didn't even have the strength to move out of her bed.

Cyra and Elena also tried to make her feel safe and secure in their house, they sometimes even talked to her, letting her vent all her problems and what was bothering her.

They all tried their best, and it could be noticed on Adora's face, as time passed she was returning to her old self, the one who didn't care much about things, the one who laughed at anything, but there was still something bothering Catra she didn't know what it was but she was happy Adora was by her side.

And as days passed she would find out that the issue was the tricks that Adora's mind was playing her, the constant abuse from part of her mother was occasioning Adora's sadness, even if she didn't tell anyone, Catra started to notice but she didn't know what it was until it was late.

She found out all the truth a day after Adora was admitted to the hospital, the Doctor had talked to her mother to know what they could do to help her, they had long talks, they had a night full of tears.

But they were getting better, they helped Adora in so many ways, that it could be reflected on her, it was going to be a long journey but the four of them would be together, Cyra and Elena had promised Adora that they were there for her any time she needed.

And Catra, well she hugged and kissed and spend the night demonstrating to Adora that she was special, that she was worthy,

and that she was enough just the way she was, she spent nights worshiping Adora's body, soul, and mind to make her see the truth, make her see that she would always be loved by her.

Two years ago

Mara had come after the incident, she talked to her niece and promised that she was just a phone call away, that if any of the Diaz' family or her needed anything they just needed to call her and she was going to be there, she also talked to the girls and told them that her house was for them, that if they wanted when they went to college they could live there, and that what they did.

When they found out that they going together to the same campus, they celebrated with Cyra and Elena, to then little by little they started to pack their stuff so they could move out to their new house, on vacation, they cleaned and fixed the house.

This was their new begging, and they couldn't wait to start it together

They didn't know what would happen in the future or who was coming into their lives but they didn't care that much, they had their other half by their side and that was enough.

It was day two at the hospital and Adora was still asleep, Catra was by Adora's side, she didn't leave the chair even if she was exhausted, she was afraid that if she left Adora was going to wake up and she wasn't going to be by her side, the only motive to get up was going to the bathroom, she had barely slept, Cyra and Elena were also by her side on a couch.

In the afternoon Glimmer and Bow volunteer going to get food for everyone, all of them were tired and nobody wanted to leave the blonde's side but they knew that they needed to take care of each other so someone had to get the meals.

The other half of the best friend squad hadn't returned when Adora started to stir in her bed, she was mumbling but nobody

could understand her, Adora was opening her eyes slowly so Cyra decided to step out and call a Doctor or a nurse, anybody who could help Adora.

After some general check-ups, the Doctor and some nurses left Adora with the Diaz' family, saying that they were coming later for more exams.

After they left Catra went again to Adora's side grabbing her hand, she looked at her, expecting that Adora returned her look but she never received it. Adora's eyes were fixed on her hospital blanket, her right hand was playing with it.

Catra noticed that Adora's eyes were starting to gather tears, and she was biting the inside of her cheek, nobody knew how to address the elephant in the room, they wanted to know what had happened, why she didn't have said anything before.

Before anyone could question her, Adora started to talk, "I'm sorry, I wanted to talk about it but I felt like I couldn't say a word about it"

"I felt so alone and alone in a lonely place can be dangerous, my mind went from bad to worst, each day felt like I couldn't anymore, her words kept on replaying in my head, and I for some reason I let her keep on playing with me

Some days I would stay still, sitting on the couch, looking at nothing, my mind completely blank, an hour would pass without me noticing, those hours became days, the guilt sober passed the hunger, some days I would forget to eat while other I would simply eat a little or I would gag what I ate, my mind kept on playing games with me, telling me everything Marlena said was right, that I was too irresponsible with my body, that I was to fat.

The moment I would wake up those words came to torment me, do you know how it feels that your own mother doesn't like you the way you are, that you give the best of you and it is not even enough for them, that since you were a little child you would do

everything and more they told you to do and they would say you can do more.

Her words were engraved in my brain, and each time I would look at food I felt nauseated, I swear I tried to eat, but it is not easy, sometimes I feel my throat like it was closed, or my stomach like it can fit anything so it needed to go out and it was in form of vomit, it's not easy, people said it was just a tantrum or that I could make myself eat if I wanted to, but it is not easy

And it is not easier if you've been manipulated your whole life into believing that if you weren't pretty or skinny, nobody would want you"

Catra looked at Adora and in her gray-blue eyes saw sadness and regret, she wanted to hold her so tight and never let go, the blonde's lip started to go from extreme to extreme, she was probably biting the inside of her lip and cheeks.

Catra's heart was broken, she had listened to her girlfriend speak about it before but never like this, this was so sad, she couldn't even begin to understand how Marlena could say such awful things about her daughter, one thing that Adora wanted was her mother's love but Marlena could never give her that.

Cyra and Elena tried their best to give them all their love to someone who wasn't their own flesh and bones not that did matter because Adora was their daughter in all senses, but on all those chances to give Adora love, they saw that she was grateful and happy but in her eyes was the longing, the wanting for her family, in her, it was a hole that no one could replace but it could be patch up with new memories and a new family.

Before anyone could say anything, Catra got up from her seat and hugged Adora, she hugged her with all her strength, she wanted to pour all her love into Adora, she wanted the blonde to know that she was never going to be alone, so she said it.

“I love you, okay? never forget that, I don’t care how you look, to me, you’ll always be perfect”

Adora looked into Catra’s eyes and nodded, she was about to talk but was interrupted by a door opening, the other half of the squad was entering the room.

Glimmer and Bow came back, they almost dropped the food at seeing that their friend had woken up, but before that could happen Elena grabbed the bags and they went to hug Adora.

The blonde was still in a trance, all that had happened was a big shock to her, her body had been through a lot and it wasn’t the only one, her mind also went through a rough pat, between the abuse from part of her mother and her anxiety, the corners on her mind were slowly getting dark.

This time Adora didn’t know if she would get back the pieces she lost.

Catra was watching how Adora was receiving the hugs, and how words were getting in her ears, but she knows her girlfriend wasn’t into it, she was looking at a random point in the room, faking she was listening, but her attention and thoughts were somewhere else.

And she doesn’t think anyone else notices, usually everyone thinks Adora wears her heart on her sleeve, that because she doesn’t think that she needs to hide her emotions, she likes to think that everyone should be free of expressing what it’s on their hearts and minds but on vulnerable occasions she can lie. Everyone sees her as someone who can be read easily but Adora it’s a specialist in hiding her true emotions when she really wants them hidden, everyone could only see her facade, except Catra, she had been in her life long enough to tell when she is demonstrating a different feeling than the one she is actually feeling.

But now was not the time to tell on Adora, now was the time for Catra to help and protect her.

Catra was going to have even longer talks than before, she was going to be there any time Adora requires her, and she… she is going to love Adora with all her heart, mind, body, and soul.

Now it was time for healing, trust, and love.

Chapter End Notes

So, what did you think of the chapter?, I'm so happy because like I said before I have never written so much words for just one chapter, please tell me what you think of this chapter.

Also, I'm almost done with this story, so can you tell me ideas as to what could be included in the epilogue.

Other note, I know that to some people this mean nothing but to me, it means a lot, I reached 100 kudos and I'm so excited that so many people like it, when I first publish it I really didn't think it could reach that number but I'm glad that you all had showed your support for this story. Please leave a comment and kudos, you know those bright my day

Have a happy day, night or week! :)

As they did before

Chapter Summary

> After some rough parts came to change her life, Adora is ready to be herself, she is ready to be happy.

Chapter Notes

> Hi!!!! I'm back with a new chapter, I like this one and I hope you like it too!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Love is so short, forgetting is so long" - Pablo Neruda

Adora returned to her house a day later, Catra was by her side. The doctors had told her that she needed to take some vitamins to get back the ones she lost, and some other advice on how she can take better care of herself, physically and mentally, she knew it was going to be a long journey, she's been through it in the past, but in her heart, there is hope that this time will be different, now she got more people who can help her get better, and it's not that the Diaz family didn't help her, it's more about she doesn't like being a burden and she felt that way when they were only three people by her side, and now, she will have more people who can she rely on.

Some days were harder than others, her old habits were still present but not as insisting as before. Sometimes as she was laying in her bed trying to sleep, her mother would make an appearance in her mind, her words making sleep harder to come, the bad thoughts invading her head, her hunger coming and going.

Adora was struggling to get better, her mind playing tricks with her, making her think things that weren't real, her body not cooperating, her mood changing, it was frustrating, she wanted to get better, but sometimes it felt like it was a goal out of her reach,

it was easier to drop everything she has worked on, it was easier to let go, to not keep going, but she couldn't do that.

Catra, Cyra, Elena, Bow, and Glimmer were also trying to help her, they were her support system, they were doing everything in their power to help her to take care of herself.

So she couldn't just drop everything because she was tired or because it was hard, she had to keep going for the people she loves, she had to keep fighting for them and for herself.

A month later, Adora was sited on her couch, the TV was on, in there it was a program, but she didn't know what it was about mostly because it was on just to make a noise in the background, she was reading something on her phone when the doorbell sounded, her face turned to a frown, her first thought was that maybe it was Catra, maybe she forgot her keys, but Catra would have sent a text telling her to open the door, so she discarded that thought and became more curious, she wasn't expecting anyone at her house, so it was strange.

When she opened her door, a gasp got out of her mouth, her heart pulsing really fast, in her head a strong pounding was starting. "Dad", Adora said, her voice coming shaky and weak, she didn't expect him, they haven't talked after the incident, and even then they didn't interact that much, her mother interrupting every moment.

"Hey, sunshine", Randor said, his eyes were starting to water. To say Adora was in shock was an understatement, Randor voice had come out tender, soft, loving, just like he used to talk to her when she was a kid, and he even used her childhood nickname.

Her father used to tell her that she was his little sunshine, the brightest light in his life, he called her that every day before she went to school or before going to sleep, to her father she was like a ray of sunshine, she was someone who could brighten anyone's day, that nickname was also to remind her to always shine, that until the age of 17, when she decided to be her true self to her

family, and after that suddenly they didn’t talk, so to hear that nickname after three years did things to her heart that shouldn’t be doing, feelings came to surface, but Adora tried hard to suppress them because she knew that it was better not to hope.

Adora stepped aside, letting her father pass into the house, her mind was going overdrive, her thoughts coming and making her even more anxious. What was her father doing in her house? Why just him? Where is Marlena? so many questions were roaming in her head, but any of the answers were good, well at least in her head they weren't. Then her mind went to Catra, Where was she? Adora really needs her to be in their house. Catra was always by her side, helping to calm her overthinking mind, and reminding her that it was not okay to jump to conclusions. Right now, Adora really needed Catra, but it was impossible to know if she was coming home, or if she was still at school, Adora didn’t check the time before opening the door.

They walked to the couch, Adora seated on the couch, close to the TV while Randor decided to sit on the sofa that was in front of her, he was trying to get a distance between them, knowing they weren’t on good terms.

Adora opened her mouth to speak but Randor spoke first, "I want to start saying I’m sorry, I know that I wasn’t the best father for you, and for that I'm... really sorry, you deserved more, your mother and I weren’t the best, I tried, but I never defended you against your mother, I... let her do things to you that no child deserves, and I k-know that now it may be too late and that you deserve a better apology, but I really hope you let make it up to you and maybe even apologize to you for the rest of my life", Randor had tears rolling down his cheeks, his face sad and showing how sorry he was.

Adora was still in a state of shock, her eyes were starting to water, in her chest her heart felt like it was being squeezed, she was feeling out of breath, while processing the words that came out of her father she realized she really hasn’t expected that, Adora had imagined every scenery as to why her father was there, every

single one except an apology, but there was still something bothering her, so she vocalized, "Why now? Why not when I needed you? Adora’s voice came out weak, in the last work a break in her voice could be heard.

"It's... complicated, your mother and I, we tried to get a divorce when you were two years but some lawyers had told us that we couldn’t, that we had to wait a certain time, we tried again after some years but they told me that if we were divorced she could take everything from me, everything I ever worked for, I would be in her hands, so I stayed” Randor sigh before continuing, “I stayed and tried to help you, I never understood why she did all those things but I thought it would be better for me to stay there in the house at her side and help you from the inside"

"And how did you help from the inside?", now Adora’s voice was turning angry, he wanted to justify why he stayed but that sounded more like an excuse, so he could keep his stuff, she was getting angry because her father never defended her, how he claims that it was to help her when he never did that

"Did you know that after she threw you out of the house, and you didn’t come back the next day, she decided it was a good idea to go to the police and say that her daughter was kidnapped, she was going to point at Cyra and Elena as guilty, so I stopped her because they were taking care of you and I couldn’t let them take the parents you deserved, besides it was obvious that they didn’t kidnap you, you were finally in a safe space, and I wasn’t going to let your mother take that from you”, Randor was looking at the floor, he was too ashamed by his actions, the tears were still falling down his cheeks but this time it wasn’t only him, Adora had tears in her cheeks too

Adora was still trying to understand everything, maybe her father did some things to protect her and she never realized, but it was still hard, her mother’s words were still very engraved in her mind and he never stopped those words, “So… Are you and her separated now?”, she wanted to know if her father was still in Marlena’s life, that devious woman was manipulative when she

needed or wanted something, so Adora doesn't doubt her father was also caught up in her tricks.

"Yes, I couldn't be any other minute by her side, so we filed the divorced papers, and then I came here to you, I would come before but I wasn't really sure if you wanted to see me".

"You know it's going to take time right, for me to forgive you?", Adora sighed, she really wanted to accept his apology, but it wasn't so easy, her heart was screaming at her, telling her that she needed her dad, but her head was replaying every single moment where her mother had screamed at her, has criticized her, had done so much damage her and knew that she couldn't forgive him so easily even if the problem was her mother, "Marlena hurt me… a lot, and you doing nothing also affected me".

"I know sunshine… I really want to make it up to you, but if you don't want to hear more from me, I will respect that also, what we did wasn't right, and I really wish I could go back in time to remedy all of this but that clearly it's not possible, so I still try to remedy from now on".

As her father was finishing, Adora heard a door closing not realizing that someone had opened, "Hey 'Dor, I'm home, you won't believe the day… I had", Catra turned her face from Adora to Randor then to Adora again, before any of the girls could talk, Randor stepped up from the couch, "I'll leave you alone, and... I really hope you consider what I told you", with one last look to Adora, Randor started his way to the entrance, when he was opening the door, Adora talked again as she was making her way to him.

"Dad, wait", Adora also got up from the couch, she wanted to say something but word wouldn't come out of her mouth, they were stuck, so she better ask another thing, "Do you still have the same number?... You know in case I need to talk to you".

"Yes, do you still have it?", Randor's tone was surprised, like he didn't expect that Adora had kept his phone number, even after all

these years.

Adora nodded, and Randor gave her daughter a little smile and hopeful eyes before turning to Catra, who still was close to the door, then, he said, “Thank you, for always taking care of my sunshine”, Catra just nodded, still in shock just like Adora had been when she saw her father, and with that Randor got out of the house.

Adora went to sit on the couch, Catra not far behind.

Adora didn't know what to do, her father had come to apologize for everything he did, but what Marlena did and Randor let her did, wasn't going away by just an apology, she suffered for years, she is still recovering, but in her heart, she can't find space for hate towards her father, yes she still hurting, but her father is trying, and he said that he wanted to make it up to her, her mind telling her to not forgive him because what if it happened again but her heart was screaming for her father to come back, she wanted her father back.

Catra sat down next to Adora, immediately hugging her by the waist with both arms, resting her head on Adora's shoulders, trying to give comfort to her lover.

Adora was still so focused on her thoughts, that when Catra started to talk, she jumped but realized that it was just Catra, her voice soft, “Are you alright?”

“I… don’t know”, Adora sighed, she slumped on the couch taking one of Catra’s hands, she didn’t know what she was feeling, everything was confusing. Looking at her lap, Adora started to talk, “I don't know what to do, what to feel, what to think, everything feels so much but at the same time it doesn’t feel enough, my mind and my heart are fighting against each other and I don’t know anything anymore”, in Adora’s eyes tears were gathering, she felt how her shoulder slumped, and her breathing was irregular, her hands slightly shaking and her body entering a state of panic.

Luckily Catra was by her side, years of being in each other's life helped in a lot of situations and this was one of them, over the years she learned to recognize the signs to know when Adora going on a panic attack and how to help her, she stood up from the couch, so she could kneel in front of Adora, grabbing Adora's face in between her hands, Catra started the steps to ground her, "Adora, try to breathe with me okay?"

"I- I can- I can't", Adora said trying to breathe, but each time she inhaled felt like her lungs were on fire, her eyes unfocused on the ground, her throat felt like it was closing

Catra nodded, her eyes expressing worry and sadness, "Dor, can you tell me five things you see?", this method had helped Adora to focus, to try and get her out of the panic, her breathing was still the same but at least her eyes didn't seem lost

"The- the floor, table, couch, you, your eyes", Adora focused her look on Catra, if she stayed looking at her maybe she could breathe better

"Okay, now four things you can touch or feel"

"The floor, the couch, my clothes, you"

"Good, now three things you can hear", by this step, Adora's breathing was slowly going back to normal, her head not pounding anymore, her eyes still focused on Catra's eyes

"The TV, my breathing, your voice"

"Almost done, now two things you can smell"

"Vanilla, and lavender"

"Our perfumes yeah, so one last step, one thing you can taste"

"Chocolate, I was drinking one like half an hour ago", this last part Adora said it with a shy smile on her face

After making sure Adora was better, Catra smiled at her, “Do you want to lay down?”

Adora just nodded, her breathing was calmer but her thoughts weren’t, it felt too much but she had time, she knew that Catra was going to help her with it all.

They went to their room to change into more comfortable clothes and lay down on their bed. Catra was on her left side, Adora was in front of her on her right side, they were facing each other. Adora’s face was on Catra’s chest focusing on her heartbeats, Catra kissed Adora’s head, her hands were on the blonde’s back, rubbing it up and down, they were surrounded by their love.

When only their breathing could be heard, and Catra was closing her eyes, she heard a voice, Adora wasn’t asleep as she supposed, “Do you think I am a fool or naive, for wanting to give him a second chance?”, her voice was barely a whisper like she didn’t want to disturb their silence but needed to get out that doubt of her chest

It was silent again, Catra didn’t know what to think, for a part she didn’t think Randor deserved a second chance but in reality, he had helped Adora even if it was minimal, and for the other part, Adora deserved a good parent, yes her mothers had helped the blonde many times, but deep down Adora wanted her dad, so Catra could understand why she wanted to give him another chance

“No… well a little bit, he did hurt you, but so did I and you gave me a second chance, in reality, I think he deserves it, he is proving to you that he regrets everything he did and didn't do, he is trying to change for you and I think that has to count for something. Yes, I believe you're a little naive but that doesn't mean something bad. You know why?”

“Why”, it was a little muffled, Adora had put her head more closed to Catra’s collarbone, they wanted to be as close as possible, they liked it that way

“Because that makes you believe in every person, it makes you hope that everyone has a great side, it makes you believe that everyone can be better, you give people hope for something better, you have a great heart Adora, a great heart that it’s ready to fight for everyone you love and anyone who needs it, so yeah you’re naive but that it’s what makes you a good person, along with other things”

Adora separated just enough to look at Catra’s eyes, her blue-gray eyes were shinning, in there, several emotions were present, happiness, trust, and love. She had so much love and she wasn’t afraid of showing it.

They just are staring at each other’s eyes, the entire world feels like it’s paused, they feel like they could be here in their bed for the rest of their days and it wouldn’t be a problem.

They are getting even closer, wanting every part of their body touching each other's, they want to feel the other’s skin, they want to hear the other’s heartbeat. Catra looks at Adora’s lips to return her look at the blonde’s eyes, she sees nothing but love on those gray-blue eyes that she adores.

Catra was about to speak but Adora nods, knowing exactly what her girlfriend was going to ask, so Catra ends the little distance between them, causing their mouths to collide. Adora’s lips were soft, they tasted like chocolate and lip balm.

Their lips were dancing and exploring each other’s mouths, like it was the first time, neither Catra nor Adora could get tired of the other’s touch, at this point in their life they could recognize every single part of the of their lover’s body, they had spent years holding hands, kissing, making love, and each time it was different and special.

After separating for some air they decided it was best to take a nap and return to their activities later, after some rest, they could do what they wanted.

Adora had a lot to think but she also had a lot of time, now she was comfortable having Catra’s presence by her side, everything bad that has happened was passing. Adora couldn’t wait for her life to be calm, without problems, being happy and her issues in the past.

She could feel that good things were coming into her life, she could feel the love surrounded her and giving her hope, the hope to keep going, the hope for a better future with her loved ones, and she couldn’t wait to share all those happy moments with all her family, biological and found.

Chapter End Notes

So... What do you think of the chapter?. I can't believe we are on the second to last chapter of the story, if you want, you can consider this the last one because the next one it's an epilogue, I'm still writing it but it's almost finish, if I don't have a lot of school work maybe I can finish it and publish it this Friday or Saturday.

Please comment and leave kudos!!. Those motivate me to keep writing stories!

Thank you to everyone who kept on reading my first story (with multiple chapters), I know that maybe to a lot of people doesn't mean a lot but to me, it does.

I hope you have a good day, night and week! :)

And so it ends, with friends.

Chapter Summary

Epilogue

Chapter Notes

Hi!!!, I'm back with the last chapter of this incredible story, thank you for sticking around!!. I hope you all like the chapter

Please read the end notes!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"And as I lie here in pieces
Breakin' was just what I needed
I knew we had to end
I'll be whole, I'll be whole but I don't know when
The more that I think about it
I was better off without it
But now I have to mend
I'll be whole, I'll be whole but I don't know when"
Vera Blue, First Week

Two years later

Laying down on a blanket, Catra was admiring her girlfriend, they decided to spend their first day of vacation on a day-long date, they started doing breakfast together, then they watched some movies sitting on their couch, then went to a restaurant to have lunch to then pass their afternoon at the park and in between the last two Adora went to a flower shop and bought a bouquet with some tulips and some Daisies, those two didn't seem very well together, but Adora and Catra knew what they represented and meant to the blonde and to their relationship

Every time Adora passed in front of the flower shop it meant that she was going to buy a bouquet, and it was always the same flowers.

Adora had explained this to Catra the first time she bought them, when her blue-gray had set it on those flowers, somehow she knew they were special, they were tulips and daisies, she had told her why those specific flowers and what they meant, the tulips represented hope and true love while the daisies represented new beginnings, she wanted to share those meanings with Catra, she wanted for those meanings to always be present in her life.

That’s what Adora wanted in her life, she wanted a new start with her dad and the tulips helped her to remember that her true love was always going to be by her side, that no matter what changes come into their lives, Catra was always Adora’s other half, Catra was going to be in her life forever

She didn't buy the bouquet only for Catra as everyone thought, it was also for herself.

It was to remind her old self that there was still hope after all those rough patches on her way, it was to remind her that it was okay to have new beginnings even if you are in your twenty's or in any face of your way, it was okay to go through ups and downs with your partner.

It was to remind her that no matter what, the love of her life was always going to be by her side.

So she and Catra make sure to buy a bouquet every time they passed in front of the shop, and today wasn’t any different.

After the park, they decided to return to their house, so after some dinner, they put some blankets in their backyard and spent the night watching some stars, just like the day they had their first kiss.
They like to have this type of date, the type where they can remember their shared and special moments, where they can

enjoy each other's company without anything or anyone interrupting them, where they can feel themselves.

While they were watching the stars, Catra can really think about everything that has happened, how they have overcome several bumps in their way. She also saw how, like the stars in the sky, the bright light in Adora's eyes were blinding beautiful, maybe that's why the blonde was so enchanted by the little dots that adorned the night, they had similarities. Adora's gray-blue eyes could make any dark moment worthy, those eyes full of love and hope.

In these past two years happiness and love were always in their lives, of course like everyone, they had their bad days, Adora's habits were trying to come back but her friends and family were there helping her, Catra's guilt sometimes made an appearance but Adora always reassured her that all was in the past.

With all that has happened, they had learned a lot of stuff, about themselves and about life itself.

Now they were enjoying life like nothing could stop them. They just graduated so they were preparing a lot of things, for starters their wedding, they had to finish some details so they could get married in the fall. Catra couldn't believe that they would be getting married. The date was settled to be close to the brunette's birthday, she wanted to celebrate something as important as their union on that month, she had said that date because of the weather, and Adora had eagerly agreed, she wanted autumn threes in the background as they were promising to be always together no matter what.

They had made that promise before, but now it was a confirmation, with rings and in front of the people they loved.

They also wanted to look for better jobs and even considered studying for some degrees, they wanted to be better people, they wanted to show everyone that they could do anything.

These last two years have been for change and learning, there are downs and ups, but they try to enjoy and learn from everything that happens.

In these two years Adora has gained more weight, and she has also learned how to love herself, she has learned not to care about other people think of her, of course leaving those bad mental habits was difficult, and sometimes they’re still nagging in a corner of her mind, but Catra is there.

She is there to tell her girlfriend that she is special, beautiful, and perfect in her own way, she is there to tell her that there is nothing wrong with the way she looks, the way she acts, the way she dressed, the way she eats. There is nothing wrong with the way she loves.

These two years Adora has been more radiant, more herself, and Catra couldn't be happier for her partner.

Even if sometimes Adora feels like parts of her are missing, she knows everything will get better with time, of course, she wishes parts of her childhood were different, she wishes she could have a better mother, but something she wouldn’t change for anything in the world, because instead of one she has to mother figures, Cyra and Elena is there for her progress and cheering her in the accomplishments she does, Randor is also there, being the better parent he promised he would be.

Yes, she is not complete, parts are still healing and maybe it would take many years to heal, but she has trust in herself, she doesn’t know when it would happen but one day she is going to be whole.

Chapter End Notes

So... What did you all thought of this chapter or the story???

Thank you all for making me company during this wild ride called writing, I hope you'll like the story. This is the first story (with multiple chapters) I've written so thank you to

everyone who gave me the chance and the motivation to keep going, thank you to the people who commented and gave the story kudos you always made my day.

I have many other ideas, so if you want to know if I will publish them you can follow me on Twitter (my user it's on a previous chapter), I know I don't talk a lot in there but I keep posted about my stories.

If you ever related to some parts and don't have anyone to talk my DM'S are always open, I've experienced a lot and it's not good and it's even worse if you're alone, so if any of you needs a friend or just vent out never doubt on message me. I've written this story with two purposes, one to vent out and two to make people see that everyone suffers different and that's okay, even if you feel like it's not much remember that every feeling inside you is valid, you are valid and worthy just the way you are, never let people tell other thing.

I hope you have a great day, night and week!!!

End Notes

So, I hope you'll like it, comments and kudos are always appreciated. I don't know if I will publish weekly, but I will try, I have most of the work complete, just some details here and there.

Thanks for giving the chance to my work and I hope you'll have a great day, week or weekend! :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!